

DOMINICAN REPUBLIC SUPPLEMENTAL FIELD OFFICE MANUAL FOR PERSONNEL AND OPERATIONS

January 2020



PARTNERS *of the* AMERICAS
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Table of Contents

1. Introduction.....	8
1.1 Welcome to Partners	8
1.2 Objective and Scope	9
1.3 Management Control – Roles and Responsibilities in Headquarters	9
1.4 Implementation Control – Roles and Responsibilities in Dominican Republic	9
2. Internal Controls.....	10
2.1 Purpose and Scope	10
2.2 Approval Authority	11
2.2.1 Responsibilities of Approval and Review Authorities.....	11
3. Monthly Reconciliation of Accounts	13
3.1 Reconciliation of Assets, Liabilities & Cash Accounts	13
3.2 System of Award Management (SAM) Check Via Visual Compliance	14
4. Financial Records, Audits & Record Retention	14
4.1 Record Retention and Accounting.....	14
4.2 Filing & Records	15
4.3 Audits.....	15
4.4 Financial Reporting.....	16
5. Inventory Control	16
5.1 Equipment vs. Supplies.....	16
5.2 Inventory Control Requirements.....	16
5.3 Use of Equipment.....	17
6. Cash Management	18
6.1 Petty Cash.....	18
6.2 Exchange Rates	19
6.3 Bank Accounts.....	19
6.3.1 Monthly Bank Account Reconciliations	20
6.4 Cash Flow Advances.....	21
6.4.1 Excess Cash on Hand	21
6.5 General Cash Handling Policies	22
6.5.1 Use of Safes	22

6.5.2 Minimizing Cash Transactions	22
6.5.3 Evidence of Receipt by Payee	22
6.5.4 Periodic Cash Counts – Petty Cash Certification.....	22
7. Partners Dominican Republic General Policies	23
7.1 Anti-Corruption Policy.....	23
7.2 Anti-Discrimination	23
7.3 Anti-Sexual Harassment.....	24
7.4 Anti-Workplace Violence and Bullying.....	26
7.4.1 Harassment/Bullying Complaint Procedure	27
7.4.2 Protection from Retaliation for Harassment/Bullying Complaint.....	28
7.5 Freedom of Association	29
7.6 Freedom of Work	29
7.7 Anti-Forced Labor.....	29
7.8 Conflict of Interest	30
7.9 Confidentiality.....	31
7.10 Drug Free Workplace.....	32
7.11 Smoke Free Workplace	33
7.12 Alcohol Policy.....	34
7.13 Code of Ethics.....	34
7.14 Grievance Policy.....	36
7.15 Whistleblower Policy.....	37
7.15.1 Whistleblower Complaint Procedure.....	37
7.16 Labor Disputes	38
7.17 Hygiene, Health & Workplace Security.....	38
7.17.1 Housekeeping.....	39
7.17.2 Job Related Injury Reporting.....	39
8. Recruitment and Labor Contracts.....	40
8.1 Application Process for Personnel	40
8.1.1 Internal Recruitment.....	40
8.1.2 External Recruitment.....	40
8.1.3 Transfer within the Partners Dominican Republic	41
8.1.4 Promotion within the Partners Dominican Republic.....	41

8.2 Selection Process for Personnel	42
8.3 Employee Definition	42
8.4 Labor Contract Definition	43
8.4.1 Employee Labor Agreements.....	43
8.4.2 Contractor Agreements.....	44
8.5 Types of Labor Contracts	44
8.5.1 Payment Structure for Labor Contracts.....	45
8.5.2 Pay Structure	46
8.6 Content of Labor Contracts	46
8.7 Obligations of Binding Labor Contract	47
8.8 Termination & Suspension of Labor Contract	50
8.8.1 Temporary Suspension of Labor Contract without Liability for the Parties	51
8.8.2 Termination of Labor Contract	52
8.8.3 Work Certificate upon Termination.....	58
8.9 Probation Period 90 Days.....	58
8.10 Obligated Labor Poster	58
8.11 Mandatory Notices for Termination of Labor Contract.....	59
8.11.1 Mandatory Notices for Termination – Employer Responsibility	59
8.11.2 Mandatory Notices for Termination – Employee Responsibility	60
8.12 Statutory Benefits – Severance Pay	61
8.13 Statutory Benefits – Economic Assistance.....	62
8.14 Record Keeping for Personnel.....	63
8.14.1 Access to Personnel Records	64
9. Worktime, Workdays and Holidays	65
9.1 Normal Daytime Work Hours.....	65
9.2 Nighttime Work	65
9.3 Overtime and Limitations	65
9.4 Rest and Break Time.....	66
9.5 Weekly Rest.....	66
9.5.1 Compensatory Time for Weekly Rest.....	67
9.6 Holidays.....	67
10. Wages and Social Benefits	68

10.1 Wages	68
10.2 Wage & Leave Advances	68
10.3 Timekeeping.....	68
10.4 Pay Slips (Paystubs)	69
10.5 Bonuses & Benefits	69
10.5.1 13 th Month Bonus.....	69
10.5.2 Health Insurance	70
10.6 Wage Deductions.....	70
10.6.1 Statutory Deductions.....	70
10.6.2 Other Deductions	72
10.7 Paid Leave	72
10.7.1 Annual Leave	72
10.7.1.1 Annual Leave Payout upon Termination	73
10.7.2 Sick Leave.....	73
10.7.3 Maternity Leave (Pre and Post Natal).....	74
10.7.4 Bereavement Leave.....	74
10.7.5 Marriage Leave	74
10.7.6 Paternity Leave	74
10.8 Benefits Accruals	75
10.9 Social Benefits.....	75
10.9.1 Maternity Rights.....	75
11. Employees	76
11.1 Job Descriptions	76
11.2 Performance Evaluations	76
11.3 Salary Adjustments.....	77
11.4 Salary Advances	77
11.5 Dress Code for Personnel.....	77
11.6 Communicating Absences or Delays.....	78
11.7 Dispute Resolution.....	78
11.8 Disciplinary Action	79
11.9 Reasons for Disciplinary Action.....	79
12. Risk Assessments & Contractor/Sub-recipient Monitoring.....	81

12.1 Risk Assessment Guidelines & Process.....	81
12.2 Frequency of Risk Assessment.....	81
13. Procurement.....	81
13.1 Procurement Process.....	81
14. Travel Policies and Procedures.....	82
14.1 Policy Overview and Applicability.....	82
14.2 Requesting Travel Authorization.....	83
14.2.1 Itinerary Changes.....	84
14.3 Traveler Definitions	84
14.4 Travel Advances.....	85
14.5 Allowable and Unallowable Expenses (Applicable to All).....	85
14.5.1 Lodging – Reimbursable Based	85
14.5.2 Rental Cars – Reimbursable Based.....	86
14.5.3 Use of Personal Vehicle – Reimbursable Based	86
14.5.4 Tolls, Parking, Etc. – Reimbursable Based	87
14.5.5 Airfare and Trains – Reimbursable Based.....	87
14.5.5.1 <i>Seat Upgrades</i>	87
14.5.5.2 <i>Fly America Act</i>	88
14.5.6 Meals & Incidentals (M&IE) – Per Diem Based	89
14.5.7 All Other Miscellaneous Travel Expenses (MTE) – Reimbursable Based	89
14.5.8 Unallowable Expenses and Reimbursement Limitations.....	90
14.5.8.1 <i>Alcohol Purchases</i>	90
14.5.8.2 <i>Other Unallowable Expenses</i>	90
14.6 Per Diem for M&IE.....	91
14.6.1 M&IE Rates	91
14.6.2 M&IE Meal Breakdown	92
14.6.3 M&IE Allowable Costs.....	93
14.6.3.1 <i>M&IE Weekend Travel</i>	94
14.6.4 Per Diem M&IE – Local Field Office Staff.....	94
14.6.5 Payment of Per Diems.....	95
14.6.5.1 <i>Per Diem Payment for Local Field Office Staff</i>	95
14.7 Reimbursement Requests (Non-Per Diem Items).....	95

14.7.1 Expense Reports for Reimbursement – Local Field Office Staff.....	96
14.8 Personal Travel During Business Trips	96
14.9 Use of Partners Dominican Republic’s Vehicles	97
14.9.1 Vehicle Driving Restrictions	100
14.9.2 Vehicle Travel Restrictions	100
14.9.3 Vehicle Logs	100
14.9.4 Reporting Vehicle Accidents.....	100
14.9.5 Vehicle Repairs	102
14.9.5.1 Normal Vehicle Maintenance.....	102
14.9.5.2 Major Vehicle Repairs.....	102
14.9.6 Vehicle Insurance and Registration.....	103
Annex A.....	104
Annex B.....	105
Annex C	106
Annex D	108
Annex E	109
Annex F	110
Annex G.....	112
Annex H.....	118
Annex I	123
Annex J.....	126
Annex K.....	131
Annex L	132
Annex M.....	134
Acknowledgment of Receipt and Compliance to Policies.....	135

1. Introduction

1.1 Welcome to Partners

Welcome to Partners of the Americas!

The field office manual has been prepared specifically for Partners of the Americas employees in Dominican Republic. It will introduce the organization and information on the rights and obligations the employee has towards the Dominican Republic Field Office and, at the same time, about the rights and obligations that the Dominican Republic Field Office has towards the employee. This Manual is therefore a basic information tool for employees working in the Dominican Republic Field Office.

In this book, we try to explain the important topics related to financial, personnel and operational management. The Dominican Republic Field Office expects that all employees understand and implement all the policies and procedures found within this manual. It is the responsibility of each employee to know the policies and procedures, or when necessary, request clarification. All employees will be required to sign a [certification form](#) confirming that they have reviewed all the policies and that they will adhere to the standards set forth within this document.

When the Dominican Republic Field Office deems it appropriate to modify the policies and procedures, it will update the necessary parameters which will subsequently be disbursed to each employee in a timely manner. We ask you to contact your immediate superior or the Administrative and Financial Management if you have any doubt about your position or your working relationship with the Partners Dominican Republic, as many times as necessary.

You are the lifeblood of Partners of the Americas and, as such, we want you to find an interesting and rewarding experience in your work environment. With all due respect, I wish you every success.

John McPhail, President & CEO

1.2 Objective and Scope

The purpose of this manual is to help its users to work in accordance with the rules and philosophy of Partners of the Americas, adapted to the Labor Code in Dominican Republic, thus becoming a consultation tool with unified criteria and provide a general framework and standardized set of policies and procedures for financial, personnel and operational management in Partners of the Americas' Dominican Republic Field Office, herein after referred to as **"Partners Dominican Republic"**. The supplemental manual addresses country specific laws, regulations and policies in accordance with Dominican Republic law.

The information presented here contains the main standards of conduct Partners Dominican Republic and the most common legal regulations in the workplace.

Partners Dominican Republic is expected to comply with all the policies and procedures set forth in this manual and are encouraged to seek clarifications if questions arise. Partners Dominican Republic, (including sub-offices), must maintain a printed copy of the manual for reference.

1.3 Management Control – Roles and Responsibilities in Headquarters

The Chief Financial Officer (CFO) is the authority on the Partners Dominican Republic supplemental manual, or in absence of the CFO, an individual designated by the President and CEO. Partners Dominican Republic is encouraged to provide input, suggestions and corrections, but may not alter or change any part of this manual.

This manual will be reviewed and updated annually (if applicable) to reflect current circumstances as well as new policies and procedures. Partners Dominican Republic will be notified of updates by e-mail.

1.4 Implementation Control – Roles and Responsibilities in Dominican Republic

This manual is for the use and knowledge of all employees without exception. The contents of this manual as well as its updates will be notified to each employee for its understanding

and its application. It is the responsibility of all employees to know, understand and apply the contents of this manual in its entirety.

It is not permitted to reproduce the manual for reasons as its consultation is exclusively reserved for the employees of Partners Dominican Republic. In the event that the employee has suggestions and recommendations related to the manual, these remarks must be communicated in writing to the immediate supervisor so that he can forward it to the management.

Enforcement of this supplemental field office manual will be the responsibility of the positions below:

- Field Office (FO) Director (Project Director, Chief of Party, etc.) – This individual is the lead field office operations director in country. They are responsible for overall project/program management and the operations of the field on a day-to-day basis. This individual is also responsible for approval of all the finance operations including payment authorizations and internal controls for the in-country field office.
- Field Office (FO) Finance Manager (Admin & Finance Assistant/Manager) – This individual is the person responsible for finance operations, basic data entry, payment processing and entry, and reconciling accounts.

2. Internal Controls

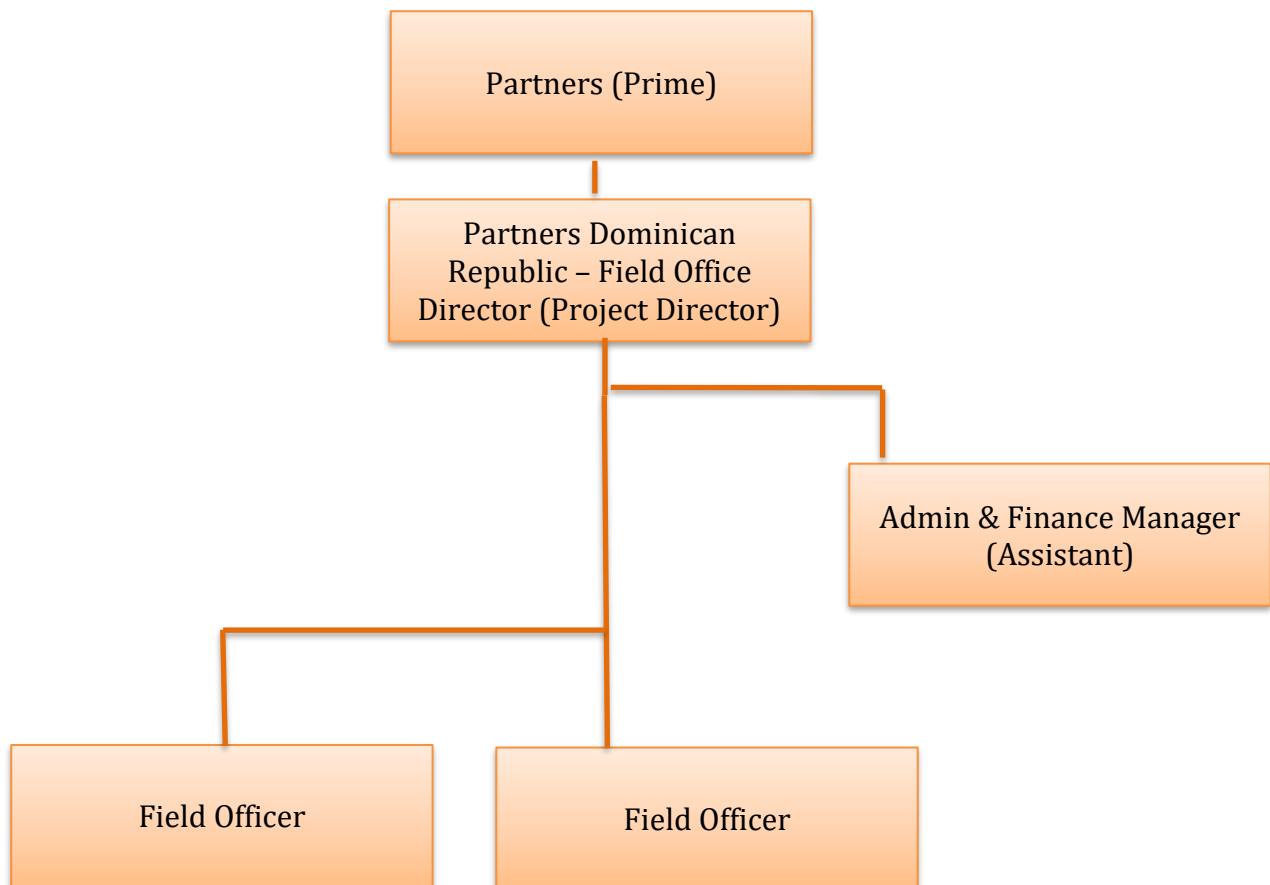
2.1 Purpose and Scope

The purpose of Internal Controls is to provide reasonable assurance that the following objectives are being accomplished:

- Reliability and integrity of information
- Compliance with policies, plans, procedures, laws and regulations
- Safeguarding of assets in Partners Dominican Republic
- Economical and efficient use of resources
- Accomplishment of established objectives and goals for operations and programs

2.2 Approval Authority

The flowchart below outlines the approval authority matrix at Partners Dominican Republic. The FO Finance Manager, supported by the FO Director, has responsibility for enforcing approval authority. Partners HQ has approval over the FO Director and must approve his/her payments, etc. In accordance with the procurement policy, all transactions valued at USD \$2,500 will automatically need to be approved by Partners HQ.



2.2.1 Responsibilities of Approval and Review Authorities

It is critical that approval authority holders not only understand what their authority levels are, but also what their responsibilities are in using their authority. The responsibilities for both approval authority holders and financial review are outlined below.

By approving an expenditure, commitment or payment, the signer is confirming that:

1. The expenditure is necessary and appropriate;
2. The item is not currently in stock or available;
3. The technical specifications are correct and adequately detailed;
4. The required forms are complete;
5. Funds are available within the budget;
6. The expenditure is in compliance with Partners HQ's policies and procedures.

Financial review is a compliance check and not an approval authority. The primary purpose of financial review is to ensure that all financial and compliance aspects of the commitment are considered. The FO Finance Manager, when signing off, is confirming that:

1. The expense has been authorized by the appropriate authorizer;
2. The expenditure is within budget guidelines;
3. The expenditure is in compliance with Partners HQ and donor policies;
4. The expense has been coded correctly;
5. The calculations are correct;
6. The required supporting documentation is in order and adequately explains the transaction; and
7. All payments, whether by check, wire transfer, etc. are being paid to the party which appears on the procurement records and/or other approval documentation. Checks or transfers may not be made out to third parties or any Partners' employees (either Partners HQ or Partners Dominican Republic) to be cashed on behalf of the vendor. Any exceptions must be approved in writing by the CFO or President & CEO.
8. All expenses are recorded at full cost and not net of taxes, etc.

An original signature on an original document is the required method of documenting an approval or review. Upward approval is required for all transactions. Under no circumstances may an originator approve their own expenses, including the FO Director.

When the authority holder is not located at Partners Dominican Republic or where an approval is required due to a temporary absence (travel, vacation, sick, etc.), the next level of authority in that office should be sought for approvals that the absent party would have normally made.

When the authority holder is permanently located outside of the office where an approval is required or is the only one authorized for a particular approval and they are out of office, the document to be signed should be printed, signed and scanned. The scanned copy should be sent back to the office requiring the approval. The scanned document must then be printed and attached.

3. Monthly Reconciliation of Accounts

3.1 Reconciliation of Assets, Liabilities & Cash Accounts

All assets and liabilities accounts (i.e. cash, accounts receivable, accounts payable and other balance sheet accounts) must be properly reconciled on a monthly basis. Evidence of the reconciliation should be maintained in Partners Dominican Republic and be sent monthly to Partners HQ. This evidence should include all supporting schedules prepared by the FO Finance Manager and approved by the FO Director prior to the submission of the reports to Partners HQ, or presentation to the auditors during the audit process.

All financial reports for both Partners Dominican Republic and all sub-awardees must be submitted to Partners HQ by the 7th of the following month. If the 7th of the month falls on a holiday or weekend, the submission deadline is the last business day prior to the 7th. Compliance with this timeline is critical to ensure expenditures are recorded in the correct month. If there are any delays or issues with meeting the deadline, field staff must immediately notify Partners HQ of the delay and provide an explanation for the nature of the delay. Partners will provide a template for monthly financial reporting. A financial report must be received each month for all bank accounts held by Partners Dominican Republic which includes all the following:

- A) Signed bank reconciliation (template provided by Partners HQ, see [Annex C](#))
- B) Copy of the bank statement(s)
- C) Expense report indicating all expenditures in the month (on the template provided by Partners, see [Annex C](#))
- D) Copies of all documentation to support the expenditures listed on the expense report
- E) If reporting is done in local currency, then a copy of the monthly average exchange rates must be submitted from the Bank of Dominican Republic.

Partners may withhold a cash flow advance request if Partners Dominican Republic fails to provide timely reporting of expenditures in accordance with the above guidelines.

3.2 System of Award Management (SAM) Check Via Visual Compliance

Partners HQ, in accordance with Federal Regulation, requires that Partners Dominican Republic run a Visual Compliance check on all recipients (individuals and entities) who are receiving any funds. The website for Visual Compliance is: <https://www.visualcompliance.com/> and the necessary login information will be provided by Partners HQ. Proof that the Visual Compliance check was done must be retained and kept along with proof of the payment, **prior to the recipient receiving any funds**. The Visual Compliance check must be run at a minimum, once per calendar year (January – December) on the first payment of the year in order to be compliant.

Each month, Partners HQ will request copies of selected Visual Compliance checks for inspection and to ensure compliance. The transactions will be selected at random.

4. Financial Records, Audits & Record Retention

4.1 Record Retention and Accounting

Partners Dominican Republic must maintain financial records, supporting documents, statistical records and all other records, to support performance of, and charges to, the

project. Such records must comply with accounting principles generally accepted in the U.S. and Dominican Republic.

Partners Dominican Republic records and any subrecipient records that pertain to the project must be retained in country for a minimum period of three years from the submission date of the final expenditure report. After three years of record retention in country, Partners Dominican Republic will need to work with Partners HQ to transport the necessary documents to the international office. Per the Department of Labor, Partners Dominican Republic are required to keep, the following records in country:

- Register of employees, with indication of their wages and work hours;
- Work interruptions and their causes;
- Overtime hours worked;
- Amount of remuneration due;
- Age and sex.

4.2 Filing & Records

The FO Director is responsible for establishing guidelines and procedures for filing and tracking. In addition, they are responsible for maintaining the general filing system or appointing another member of the management team to assist in this process. At a minimum all financial records, supporting documents, statistical records and all other records, to support performance of, and charges to, the project must be stored in a fire-proof filing cabinet with a lock. Access to the files should be restricted to the FO Director and FO Finance Manager.

4.3 Audits

Partners Dominican Republic must have an annual audit conducted in accordance with the "Guidelines for Financial Audits Contracted by Foreign Recipients" https://www.usaid.gov/sites/default/files/documents/1868/591maa_new.pdf, for any fiscal year (January – December) in which Partners Dominican Republic expends a combined total of USD \$750,000 or more in all Federal awards. Any donor can make a request and has

the right to conduct an audit any time during the life of a project/program that the donor funds. Any annual audit must be conducted in coordination with Partners HQ. The terms of reference and the selection of the audit firm must be approved by the CFO at Partners HQ.

Partners HQ retains the right to conduct a financial review, require an audit, or otherwise ensure adequate accountability of organizations expending federal funds, regardless of the audit requirements above.

4.4 Financial Reporting

The FO Finance Manager will provide the FO Director with the below reports monthly:

1. Balance Sheet
2. Income Statement
3. Report on Budget versus Actuals

The FO Director is responsible for the review and approval of the above financial statements. Copies of the approved financial statements must be submitted to Partners HQ quarterly.

5. Inventory Control

5.1 Equipment vs. Supplies

- **Equipment** means tangible personal property (including information technology systems) having a useful life of more than one year and a per-unit acquisition cost which equals or exceeds USD \$5,000.
- **Supplies** means all tangible personal property other than those described in equipment (above). A computing device (e.g. computers, etc.) is a supply if the acquisition cost is less than USD \$5,000, regardless of the length of its useful life.

5.2 Inventory Control Requirements

A physical inventory of Partners Dominican Republic must be taken, and the results reconciled with Partners Dominican Republic's records at least once every year in January.

The monetary value threshold for accounting of inventory items (e.g. furniture, equipment and fixtures) in Dominican Republic is USD \$500 per item.

The document “Master Equipment & Supply Listing”, found in [Annex A](#) must be submitted to Partners HQ annually no later than January 31st. The FO Finance Manager must certify and reconcile to the books the “Master Equipment & Supply Listing” and the FO Director must review and approve.

5.3 Use of Equipment

Partners Dominican Republic strives to ensure that its employees have modern and adequate equipment to make their work easier and more efficient.

Responsibilities for the proper use of equipment:

- Handle the assigned equipment with care;
- Monitor the optimal operation of assigned equipment;
- If for any reason equipment from another source is to be used, the employee must ensure that it contains no viruses in order to preserve information on the organization's computer network;
- Report any fault or loss of equipment immediately; and
- Facilitate equipment access to technical and maintenance services.

Partners Dominican Republic does not authorize the following activities:

- Installation of programs that do not have their corresponding license;
- Use of copied programs that are not for the exclusive use of Partners Dominican Republic;
- Installation and use of games, movies, etc.;
- Use of programs that may affect the operation of Partners Dominican Republic network;
- Introduction of elements that damage the equipment;
- Block operating systems without notice;

- Create passwords without sharing them with the systems manager and the Administration Manager, preventing access to working documents;
- Delete, without warning the information necessary for the execution of programs;
- Any conduct with bad faith or destructive intent that interferes with the good work of other employees.

Use of Printing and Copying Equipment

The use of printers and photocopying machines is exclusively reserved for work related to Partners Dominican Republic projects.

Use of the Internet and Chat Software

Use of the internet should be for work purposes only. Software programs for chatting within the organization such as Skype, WhatsApp, etc. is permitted for office use.

It is strictly forbidden to use chat software such as Facebook, Instagram, or other social media sites, unless for explicit Partners Dominican Republic work. Access to adult and similar web sites is strictly prohibited. Note that Partners Dominican Republic reserves the right to monitor all company equipment, emails, etc. to ensure its proper use.

Use of Audio Equipment

The use of radio, tape recorder or CDs is not prohibited. However, employees must refrain from doing so in places where their use may interfere with the normal development of their employees' work. In any case, the volume of the music must be of low intensity.

6. Cash Management

6.1 Petty Cash

This is an imprest system of cash control which is used for day-to-day expenditure of items less than USD \$25.00 or its Dominican Peso equivocal. The fixed float amount of petty cash is USD \$300.00 or its Dominican Peso equivocal. Unless otherwise delegated, the FO Finance Manager is responsible for the petty cash system, including disbursement and reconciliation.

A petty cash log is to be maintained by the FO Finance Manager. The date and amount of petty cash taken must be recorded on the petty cash log. The FO Finance Manager will complete the details of the expenditure and track all receipts associated with petty cash. At the end of each month, a petty cash count should be completed to confirm the balance; a template is provided in [Annex B](#).

When the balance of the petty cash reaches USD \$50.00, the FO Finance Manager will reconcile the petty cash, ensuring that all receipts and vouchers are accounted for, and replace funds by drawing a check made out to petty cash. When petty cash is reimbursed by check, the transaction is recorded in the accounting software allocating each item to the appropriate line item. The FO Director is responsible for review and approval of the petty cash reconciliation. The FO Director is also responsible for surprise cash count to be done no less than quarterly and at the end of fiscal year closure.

6.2 Exchange Rates

To report all revenues and expenditures, Partners Dominican Republic uses a monthly average exchange rate. Proof of exchange rate must be submitted monthly to Partners HQ with the monthly field expenditure reports.

6.3 Bank Accounts

Partners Dominican Republic is authorized to set up one bank account to receive project funds dominated in Dominican Pesos. If any additional bank accounts are required, the FO Director must request permission and approval in writing form to the CFO. The goal is to keep Partners Dominican Republic's bank accounts to the minimum number needed.

The bank accounts should only be used for the purpose of the project and in the name of Partners Dominican Republic. Transactions related to other projects will not be permitted. The bank account should have a HQ staff member and a minimum of two signatories, the FO Finance Manager and the FO Director. The FO Director will approve all the payments and

sign all checks. For payments and checks exceeding USD \$750.00, the FO Finance Manager must sign as a second signatory.

Information on any new bank account must be sent to Partners HQ and provide the following information: the name on the account, account number, bank name, type of account, list of signatories on the account and current balance. Changes to the signatories on the account must be approved by the FO Director and notification should be provided to Partners HQ. Upon hiring or termination of employee with signatory power, the bank account signatories must be updated accordingly.

6.3.1 Monthly Bank Account Reconciliations

The monthly bank statement will be used to reconcile the account each month. Each bank account should have a separate general ledger account, differentiated by sub-code.

At the end of each month, Partners Dominican Republic will receive a monthly bank statement from the bank. Note an official statement must be obtained from the bank for each account, regardless of whether any transactions took place during the month. If the reconciliation is done in Dominican Pesos, then a proof of exchange rate to USD must be provided.

The purpose of the monthly bank reconciliation is to reconcile the balance shown on the bank statement with the ending balance on the general ledger journal. Each transaction (check, wire, advance, etc.) must be recorded separately. A lump sum total will not be permissible. All bank reconciliations must be done on the field report expenditure template and reconciliation, found in [Annex C](#).

The reconciliation tab should not be used to restate the monthly bank activity but should be used to show any outstanding transactions that occurred during the month but have not yet been reflected on the bank statement. The prior month's bank reconciliation must be checked for any items that remain outstanding. Transactions that remain uncleared from previous months should be promptly researched with the bank or the payee. The tab for

financial field report of general ledger activities should show all financial transactions occurring in the month.

Once the full bank reconciliation is completed, the FO Finance Manager will be responsible for submitting to Partners HQ the following: bank reconciliation, copy of the bank statement, full financial field report (general ledger report), and copies of all receipts by the 7th of each month for the prior month's expenditures as indicated in [3.1 Reconciliation of Assets, Liabilities & Cash Accounts](#).

6.4 Cash Flow Advances

Partners Dominican Republic may request up to 30 days of cash needs based on the monthly cash flow projection. Cash may be drawn once a month on the first of the month. A cash flow request must be used for all cash requests to Partners HQ, the template is provided in [Annex D](#). Funding requests should be sent to Partners HQ by the 7th of the month to be processed on mid-month wire and check release cycle. Partners Dominican Republic should plan enough lead time when requesting cash to take into account the wire processing time by the bank and Partners HQ. Cash flow advances must be cleared monthly through submission of a financial report that is submitted to Partners HQ in accordance with [3.1 Reconciliation of Assets, Liabilities & Cash Accounts](#). Often the cash flow advances will not clear entirely each month, and therefore any leftover funds should be taken into consideration as cash on hand when determining the next month's cash flow request. If financial reports are not submitted on time, additional advances to Partners Dominican Republic may be held at the discretion of the CFO.

6.4.1 Excess Cash on Hand

Excess funds are defined as cash in excess of 60 days for Dominican Republic operations. As having an excess of funds in the Dominican Republic can pose a risk, Partners Dominican Republic should consult with Partners HQ to determine the best course of action to rectify the situation.

6.5 General Cash Handling Policies

Below are the general guidelines that Partners Dominican Republic is required to meet in order to ensure compliance and safeguarding of cash.

6.5.1 Use of Safes

Partners Dominican Republic is required to use a fireproof safe for the storage of office cash. Access to the safe should be strictly controlled. A set of keys should be kept by the FO Director only.

6.5.2 Minimizing Cash Transactions

Given the inherent risks associated with cash handling, Partners Dominican Republic must always use other means of payment whenever possible, such as a bank debit card, checks or wire transfers and avoid use of petty cash and advances. The maximum cash payment that is permissible is USD \$250. Transactions over this threshold must be made with another payment method such as a bank debit card, check or wire transfer.

6.5.3 Evidence of Receipt by Payee

To prevent duplicate payments or claims of discrepancies, all cash payments must be documented by evidence of receipt by the payee. This means that the recipient of the payment must sign that the cash was received in total at the time of payment. A numbered receipt should be prepared in duplicate indicating the amount and date and should be signed by the recipient. One copy should be given to the payee and one copy should be retained and included with the voucher documentation.

6.5.4 Periodic Cash Counts – Petty Cash Certification

Cash balances should be physically counted periodically to ensure that cash journal/receipts balances match the actual cash on hand. These cash counts should be done in accordance with [Section 6.1 Petty Cash](#). Petty cash certifications should conform to the following general guidelines:

- Cash counts should be done discreetly, out of general view and should be undisturbed.

- Counts should be performed by a minimum of two people. One should serve as the counter and the other as a witness of the count. A template of the Petty Cash Certification can be found in [Annex E](#) which must be completed each time.
- Cash counts should be performed each month and at random. Note that Partners HQ reserves the right to request a Petty Cash Certification at any time.
- Any overages or underages must be recorded in the cash journal at month end in order to reconcile with the final count. Discrepancies may not be held over to future periods. The cause for any overages or underages must be further researched and appropriate action taken to ensure that it does not happen in the future. Partners HQ must be notified of any discrepancies.

7. Partners Dominican Republic General Policies

7.1 Anti-Corruption Policy

Partners Dominican Republic and its affiliates must have a zero-tolerance against bribery and corruption. The objective of the anti-corruption policy is to ensure that appropriate anti-corruption and bribery procedures are in place to avoid any violations of relevant laws and regulations. This policy applies to all officers, directors, shareholders, employees and appointed third party representatives. For a copy of the full policy, please reference the Partners General Field Office Manual.

7.2 Anti-Discrimination

Partners Dominican Republic prohibits all kinds of discrimination to access employment or during the provision of the service. Partners Dominican Republic defines discrimination as any distinction, exclusion or preference based on race, color, sex, gender, age, religion, language, disability, nationality, sexual orientation, economic situation, union or religious belief, political or philosophical opinion, social or personal condition, national ancestry or social origin, that results in destroying or altering the equality of chances or treatment in employments or occupation. Equal pay is guaranteed for work of equal value, without gender or other discrimination and under identical conditions of capacity, efficiency and seniority.

Distinctions, exclusions or preferences based on qualifications required for a given job will not be considered as discrimination. Special positive measures aimed at achieving effective equality of opportunity and treatment between disabled workers and other workers should not be regarded as discriminatory towards the latter. The Dominican Republic Constitution provides that all workers are equal before the law and benefit from the same protection and treatment from institutions, authorities and other people and enjoy the same rights, freedoms and opportunities, without any discrimination. Partners Dominican Republic promotes diversity and equal opportunity in the workplace in accordance with all applicable local laws. If you believe that you have been the victim of any type of discrimination or are aware of such conduct, you must promptly notify your supervisor, FO Director or Partners HQ. An employee who has made a report of questionable conduct and who subsequently believes he or she has been subjected to retaliation of any kind by any Partners Dominican Republic or Partners HQ employee is directed to immediately report it to the FO Director or the appropriate party at Partners HQ. Anyone found to be engaging in any type of unlawful discrimination will be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment. All Partners Dominican Republic employees have the responsibility to maintain honesty, integrity and efficiency, and to reassure their conduct and commitment to the highest ethical standards. It is important to emphasize that all employees are important. The development and success of Partners Dominican Republic depends on the interest and creativity of its employees in the work. They must maintain good relationships and treat others kindly, creating a harmonious work environment and excellent employee relationships including equality of opportunity without discrimination or harassment.

7.3 Anti-Sexual Harassment

The Partners Dominican Republic prohibits all forms of sexual harassment. Sexual harassment constitutes any order, threat, constriction or offer intended to obtain favors of a sexual nature, made by a person (male or female) who abuses the authority conferred on them by their duties. It also refers to any physical behavior, verbal or not, of sexual nature,

affecting women and men's dignity, and deemed inappropriate, unreasonable and offensive for the worker.

The evidence of sexual harassment in the workplace is established if the workers perceive that their reaction to such behavior:

1. Is a condition to keep the job and/or;
2. Will have an impact on decisions concerning their job and/or;
3. Will have an impact on their performance.

Sexual harassment can also come from a behavior that creates a hostile, threatening and humiliating environment. It is forbidden for the employer to take actions against the worker that may be considered sexual harassment, or to support or not intervene in the event that it is carried out by its representatives. Partners Dominican Republic is committed to providing a work environment free of any form of verbal or physical discrimination and abuse based on race, color, sex, gender, age, religion, language, disability, nationality, sexual orientation, economic situation, union or religious belief, political or philosophical opinion, social or personal condition, national ancestry or social origin, or for any other purpose. It is Partners Dominican Republic policy to prohibit harassment between employees. The purpose of this philosophy is not to regulate the moral behavior of employees, but rather to ensure professional behavior at work. Employee harassment refers to the use of epithets, nicknames, threats, derogatory comments, offensive jokes, sexual insinuations, requests for sexual favors, and any other type of verbal or similar physical contact. Any employee who considers that he is subject to discrimination and harassment will have to report this situation to his/her immediate supervisor, FO Director or Partners HQ so that the corresponding investigation can be carried out and that the measures that the case deserves to be taken. The supervisor, FO Director or Partners HQ shall report the cases of sexual harassment to local authorities, for further investigation. Sexual harassment is punishable by law with one year in prison and fined five thousand to ten pesos. Sexual harassment in workplaces results in justified resignation in accordance with the provisions of articles 96

and following of the Labor Code, without prejudice to other actions that the victim may attempt especially under criminal regulations.

7.4 Anti-Workplace Violence and Bullying

To protect the welfare of our staff from instances of violence in the workplace, Partners Dominican Republic has implemented a violence prevention policy. Partners Dominican Republic strongly believes that all employees should be treated with dignity and respect and that each employee is responsible for her or his actions and consequences. Thus, acts of violence and threats of violence will not be tolerated. The carrying of weapons including, but not limited to, firearms and knives on company or client premises is strictly prohibited. According to article 88 of the Labor Code ordinal 3, 4 and 5, the employer may terminate the employment contract by dismissing the worker for any of the following reasons:

3. - For incurring the worker during his work in acts or attempts at violence, insults or ill-treatment against the employer or his relatives under his dependence;

4. - For committing the worker, against any of his colleagues, any of the acts listed in the preceding paragraph, if this alters the order of the place where he works;

5. - For committing the worker, off-duty, against the employer or relatives who depend on him, or against the heads of the undertaking, some of the acts referred to in the third ordinal.

In the same way, and according to the article 97 ordinals 4 and 5 of the Labor Code, the worker may terminate the employment contract, submitting his resignation, for any of the following reasons:

4. -By incurring the employer, its relatives or dependents who act with the express or tacit consent of the employer within the service, in acts or attempts at violence, insults or ill treatment against the worker or his spouse, parents, children or siblings;

5. -By incurring the same persons in the acts referred to in the preceding paragraph, outside the service, if they are of such seriousness that make impossible to fulfill the contract;

A worker who submits his resignation and leaves work for any of the reasons listed above is not liable.

Additionally, Partners Dominican Republic does not allow workplace bullying. Partners Dominican Republic defines bullying as “repeated inappropriate behavior, either direct or indirect, whether verbal, physical or otherwise, conducted by one or more persons against another or others, at the place of work and/or in the course of employment.” Such behavior violates the company Code of Ethics, which clearly states that all employees will be treated with dignity and respect. Bullying may be intentional or unintentional. However, it must be noted that where an allegation of bullying is made, the intention of the alleged bully is irrelevant and will not be given consideration when meting out discipline. As in sexual harassment, it is the effect of the behavior upon the individual that is important. Partners Dominican Republic considers the following types of behavior examples of bullying:

- Verbal bullying: Slandering, ridiculing or maligning a person or his/her family; persistent name calling that is hurtful, insulting or humiliating; using a person as the butt of jokes; abusive and offensive remarks.
- Physical bullying: Pushing, shoving, kicking, poking, tripping, assault or threat of physical assault; damage to a person’s work area or property.
- Gesture bullying: Nonverbal threatening gestures or glances that convey threatening messages.
- Exclusion: Socially or physically excluding or disregarding a person in work-related activities.

Any violation of this policy may lead to disciplinary action, up to, and including termination. Additionally, employees have a “duty to warn” their supervisors, FO Director or Partners HQ of any suspicious workplace activity, situations or incidents that appear problematic. This includes, but is not limited to, threats or acts of violence, aggressive behavior, and threatening comments or remarks.

7.4.1 Harassment/Bullying Complaint Procedure

If you believe you have been subjected to prohibited harassment or you are aware of any such conduct, the incident must be reported immediately. We ask that any person who has witnessed or been the subject of harassment contact our independent Human Resource (HR)

Consultant, Foster Thomas. A confidential hotline at +1 (202) 247-9610 has been set up for you to report your concern via voicemail message. The voicemail is monitored by an HR Consultant from Foster Thomas who will review all messages and promptly contact you to discuss your concern and to gain a full understanding of the situation. The HR Consultant will then provide an overview of the situation to the Ethics Committee of the Board. The Ethics Committee will then review the case and make a determination of whether the case should be referred to the President (or, in appropriate circumstances, to another member of Senior Management or the FO Director) for further action. If the complainant provides no identifying information in the message, Foster Thomas will relay the complaint directly to the Ethics Committee for review.

Alternatively, or in addition to the confidential hotline, you may report harassment to your supervisor, FO Director or Partners HQ, as you feel comfortable. Such complaints must be recorded in writing, either by the complainant or by the supervisor/FO Director to whom it is reported. A Harassment Complaint Form is available in [Annex F](#). Any supervisor or FO Director who becomes aware of possible harassment or retaliation must immediately advise a member of Partners HQ so it can be investigated in a timely and confidential manner.

All harassment complaints will be promptly and thoroughly investigated, and each complaint will be handled as confidentially as possible under the circumstances. Complaints will be investigated impartially and if found to be truthful, Partners Dominican Republic will take immediate corrective action. Anyone found to have engaged in harassment will be subject to appropriate disciplinary action up to, and including, termination of employment.

7.4.2 Protection from Retaliation for Harassment/Bullying Complaint

Partners Dominican Republic prohibits any retaliation against employees who legitimately exercise their rights under this policy or who participate in an investigation. There is to be no interference, coercion, discrimination, reprisal or retaliation against any employee for making a truthful, good-faith complaint or report of a violation. Employees who believe they are being discriminated against as a result of having legitimately filed a complaint or having

truthfully participated in an investigation should immediately notify their supervisor, FO Director or Partners HQ.

7.5 Freedom of Association

Dominican Republic law recognizes and protects freedom of association. Workers may exercise this right without discrimination and without being subject to prior authorization. These workers must only comply with the requirements established by law. It is prohibited for the employer to:

1. Influence to restrict the right of workers to enter or not enter a workers union or to withdraw from the union to which they belong or to remain in it.
2. To lobbying on workers to vote for certain candidacy in the election of officials or representatives of a workers union.
3. To fire the worker who participates in the formation of a union or ceases to be a member of one;
4. To execute against their workers the sanctions imposed against them by the union to which they belong.

7.6 Freedom of Work

In accordance with Article 62 of the Constitution, Partners Dominican Republic recognizes the freedom to work. No one can limit or prevent another from dedicating himself/herself to their profession, or force them to work against their will Partners Dominican Republic may not assign or alienate the rights that each individual has under their contract or employment relationship and will not restrict any individual's freedom to work or resign

7.7 Anti-Forced Labor

The Partners Dominican Republic prohibits all forced labor. Forced labor shall mean any work or service exacted from an individual under the threat of any penalty and for which the individual has not voluntarily offered himself. No citizen can be forced into forced labor except in the case of a legal conviction.

7.8 Conflict of Interest

Partners Dominican Republic requires that all potential conflicts of interest be reported immediately to the FO Director and Partners HQ. A personal conflict of interest is a situation in which an employee, or entity representative has a financial interest, personal activity or relationship that could impair the employee's ability to act impartially when performing activities on behalf of Partners Dominican Republic. To avoid a conflict of interest, Partners Dominican Republic does not allow any employee, entity representative or any member of an employee's immediate family to receive a sub-award or have any financial or other interest in the entity selected for a sub-award without disclosing the conflict. Additionally, all employees, and representatives of Partners Dominican Republic must neither solicit nor accept gratuities, favors, or anything of monetary value from sub-recipients or prospective sub-recipients. Any outside business dealings of Partners Dominican Republic's employees must be legal and not conflict in any manner with Partners Dominican Republic's operations. Outside business dealings include, but are not limited to, any investments, loans, employment, or business ownership by Partners Dominican Republic's employees.

Furthermore, contracts or transactions (i) between Partners and one or more of its board members, officers, or employees, or (ii) between Partners and any corporation, partnership, association or other organization in which one or more of its board members, officers or employees are directors or officers, or have a financial interest, shall not be void or voidable solely for this reason, or solely because the board member, officer or employee is present at or participates in any meeting which authorizes the contract or transaction, or solely because his, her, or their votes are counted for such purpose, if:

1. The material facts regarding the relationship or interest are disclosed or are known to the Board of Directors, and the Board of Directors in good faith authorized the contract or transaction by the affirmative votes of a majority of the disinterested board members or officers, even though the disinterested board members or officers may then become less than a quorum; or

2. The material facts regarding the relationship or interest are disclosed or are known to the Board of Directors and officers voting thereon and the contract or transaction is specifically approved in good faith by a vote of the Board of Directors; or
3. The contract or transaction is fair to Partners as of the time it is authorized, approved or ratified by the Board of Directors.

Common or interested Board members or officers may be counted in determining a quorum at any meeting of the Board of Directors which authorizes the contract or transaction, provided, however, that the interested person or persons shall be excluded from the room during the discussion of the contract or transaction in question and during the vote thereon.

7.9 Confidentiality

Partners Dominican Republic's work makes it essential that employees and consultants do not divulge proprietary company information unless expressly authorized by an officer of the company. Partners Dominican Republic's employees and independent contractors may have access to and become acquainted with proprietary and confidential information such as client lists, rates, financial records, internal structure, internal policies, publications, inventories, computer software and related documentation and similar information, which is owned by Partners Dominican Republic and which is regularly used in the operation of the business of the company. All employee and consultant agree to not use such proprietary or confidential information obtained during employment or contractual relationship with Partners Dominican Republic as a means of making private profit.

Additionally, certain information concerning Partners Dominican Republic's business is a valuable, special and unique asset of the company. Employees and consultants agree not to disclose Partners Dominican Republic's proprietary or confidential information to any person or entity for any reason, except as required in the course of employment or contractual relationship, or required by law or court order; and further agree not to make use of such information his/her own benefit or the private benefit of others. The employer may terminate the employment contract without liability, when the worker has disclosed

manufacturing secrets or disclosed matters of a reserved nature to the detriment of the company.

All files, records, documents, drawings, specifications, equipment and similar items relating to the business of Partners Dominican Republic, including computer software or software documentation, shall remain the exclusive property of Partners Dominican Republic and shall not be reproduced, removed or transmitted from the premises of the company under any circumstances without the prior written consent of the Partners Dominican Republic. Upon termination of employment with Partners Dominican Republic, employees and consultants are required to return all company property to the FO Director.

Employees and consultants also agree that if any trade secret, formula, device, technology, technical information, process, etc. ("invention") is made during the course of employment or contractual relationship, alone or jointly with others which is made with Partners Dominican Republic's equipment, supplies, facilities, trade secrets or time, or which relates to the business of Partners Dominican Republic, or which results from any work performed by me for Partners Dominican Republic, such employee shall immediately communicate this fact by written. If within two months of the date on which the employer has received such communication or has become aware of the invention by any other means, applying the earliest date, the employer notifies in writing to the employee of his interest in the invention, it will belong to the employer and the right to the patent will be deemed to have belonged to the employer from the beginning. However, the employee shall be entitled to equitable remuneration taking into account his salary and the estimated economic value of the invention. In the place of agreement between the parties, remuneration shall be fixed by the competent court. In the event that the employer fails to notify within the prescribed time limit, the right to the patent shall belong to the employee. Any violation of these policies may lead to disciplinary action, up to, and including termination.

7.10 Drug Free Workplace

It is the policy of Partners Dominican Republic to provide staff members with a working environment that is free from the problems associated with the use of illegal drugs. The use

of illegal drugs is inconsistent with the behavior expected of staff members and subjects Partners Dominican Republic to unacceptable risks of workplace accidents or other failures that would undermine Partners Dominican Republic's ability to operate effectively and efficiently.

In addition, the use of illegal drugs is contrary to the mission of Partners Dominican Republic, which includes providing drug prevention education to communities in Latin America, the Caribbean and the United States. In order to carry out this mission, Partners employees must set an example in their behavior inside and outside the workplace. Therefore, employees found to be engaged in the use of illegal drugs or the unlawful manufacture, distribution, or dispensing of a controlled substance, either in or outside the Partners Dominican Republic's workplace, are in violation of Partners Dominican Republic's policies and are subject to disciplinary action, which may include termination. Each staff member must agree to notify Partners Dominican Republic of any criminal drug statute conviction for a violation occurring in the workplace no later than five (5) days after such conviction. Non-compliance with this policy will result in disciplinary action or report of the employee to the Dominican authorities. Possession of controlled substances (drugs) are punished by law with imprisonment of six (6) months to two (2) years, and a fine of one thousand five hundred (RD\$1,500.00) to two thousand five hundred pesos (RD\$2,500.00) according to the law number 50-88.

7.11 Smoke Free Workplace

It is the policy of Partners Dominican Republic to prohibit smoking on all Partners Dominican Republic's premises in order to provide and maintain a safe and healthy work environment for all employees. Smoking is defined as the "act of lighting, smoking or carrying a lighted or smoldering cigar, cigarette or pipe of any kind."

The smoke-free workplace policy applies to:

- All areas of Partners Dominican Republic building
- All visitors to the Partners Dominican Republic

- All staff and consultants working on Partners Dominican Republic's premises

Smoking is permitted outside the building where designated. Employees who violate the smoking policy will be subject to disciplinary action and sanctions according law number 48-00.

7.12 Alcohol Policy

An employee or representative whose use of alcohol adversely affects job performance is subject to disciplinary action, which may include discharge. Partners Dominican Republic may also require that an employee seek assistance and/or counseling services as a condition of employment in appropriate circumstances.

7.13 Code of Ethics

Partners Dominican Republic has established the below Code of Conduct. It has consequently incorporated these standards, not only in relation with its employees, but also with its consultants, and where the non-respect of all or one of them is a justifying cause of termination of an employee contract or the end of a specific job. Each employee, volunteer, consultant and representative and member of the Partners Network is expected to adhere to a high standard of ethical conduct. The good name of Partners Dominican Republic depends on the way its network and representatives conduct business and the way the public perceives that conduct. Unethical actions, or the appearance of unethical actions, are not acceptable.

Below is Partners Dominican Republic standard code of conduct principals:

1. Sexual exploitation and abuse by employees is a serious misconduct that may result in termination of the employee's contract.
2. Sexual activity with children (persons under 18 years of age) is prohibited without involving the age established in the country. It is not accepted as a defense that there is a misleading assessment of the age of the child.

3. The exchange of money, employment of goods or services for sex, including sexual favors or other forms of behavior used to humiliate, degrade or exploit, is prohibited. This includes the exchange of assistance that must be addressed to the beneficiaries.
4. Sexual relations between humanitarian workers and beneficiaries are strongly censored because they are based on inherent inequalities. This type of relationship transgresses and violates the credibility and integrity of the work of humanitarian assistance.
5. In the event that an employee of the Humanitarian Section is aware of or makes reference to suspicious behavior related to sexual abuse by a co-worker, whether working in the same office or not, he or she should report it to your supervisor or Partners HQ.
6. Humanitarian staff is required to create and maintain an environment that prevents sexual exploitation and abuse and can promote the implementation of a code of conduct. Managers at all levels have special responsibilities to support and develop systems that maintain this environment.
7. All persons interacting with or representing the Partners Network should maintain the confidentiality of information entrusted to them by Partners Dominican Republic and any other confidential information about the organization, its activities, partners, funders, stakeholders or suppliers, that comes to them, from whatever source, except when disclosure is authorized or legally mandated.
8. Persons interacting with or representing Partners Dominican Republic in a foreign country are responsible for knowing and complying with these laws. Furthermore, anyone interacting with or representing the Partners Network must also take care to understand and respect the cultures and customs of the countries where Partners operates. Anyone working in the international arena should be aware of the US Foreign Corrupt Practices Act. The Act prohibits giving anything of value to officials of foreign governments in order to obtain or retain business. It is prohibited for any representative of Partners Dominican Republic or its network to engage in bribery, kickbacks, payoffs or other corrupt business practices. It is also Partners Dominican

Republic's policy to fully comply with all applicable US export, customs and trade control and regulations, licensing/trademarking/copyright requirements and other relevant US and international laws.

9. Partners Dominican Republic intends to provide a pleasant, healthful, comfortable, and professional atmosphere that is free from intimidation, hostility or other offenses which might interfere with the pursuit of our mission. Moreover, Partners Dominican Republic does not tolerate discrimination based on race, color, sex, gender, age, religion, language, disability, nationality, sexual orientation, economic situation, union or religious belief, political or philosophical opinion, social or personal condition, national ancestry or social origin, or any other legally prohibited characteristic. Harassment or discrimination based on sex or any other legally prohibited basis is illegal and is contrary to the policy of Partners Dominican Republic.

If you know of or suspect a violation of applicable laws, rules or regulations or this Code, you must immediately report that information to the FO Director and Partners HQ. Individuals can also contact Partners confidential hotline at 202-247-9610. Partners HQ will determine, or shall designate appropriate persons to determine, appropriate action in response to violations of this Code.

Partners Dominican Republic prohibits any retaliation against anyone who makes a good faith report of a suspected violation or who participates in an investigation. There is to be no interference, coercion, discrimination, reprisal or retaliation against any person for making a valid and truthful complaint or good faith report of a violation. Nothing in this policy is meant to, nor should it be interpreted to, in any way limit your rights under any applicable federal, state, or local laws.

7.14 Grievance Policy

Partners Dominican Republic provides employees with the opportunity to bring work-related problems and concerns to the attention of management and to resolve such problems fairly and promptly. Any employee who feels that s/he has been treated unfairly or inequitably regarding a condition or action affecting employment should bring the matter to

the attention the FO Director, Partners HQ or to the confidential hotline at +1 (202) 247-9610.

7.15 Whistleblower Policy

Employees have the duty to comply with all applicable laws and to assist Partners Dominican Republic to ensure legal compliance. Partners Dominican Republic encourages its employees to report improper activities in the workplace and will protect employees from retaliation for making any such report in good faith. Employees have the right to report, without suffering retaliation, any activity by the organization or its employees that the employee reasonably believes:

- Violates any local law;
- Violates or amounts to noncompliance with any local rule or regulation;
- Violates fiduciary responsibilities by a corporation to its stakeholders or employees.

In addition, employees can refuse to participate in an activity that would result in a violation of, or noncompliance with, any local statutes, rules or regulations. Employees are also protected from retaliation for having exercised any of these rights in any former employment. The whistleblower protection policy does not entitle employees to violate a confidential privilege of the organization (such as attorney-client privilege) or improperly disclose trade-secret information.

7.15.1 Whistleblower Complaint Procedure

Any employee who suspects a violation of ethics or legal compliance is required to report the situation(s) to the FO Director, Partners HQ or the confidential hotline at +1 (202) 247-9610.

7.15.2 Protection from Retaliation for Whistleblower Complaint

Partners Dominican Republic is prohibited from discharging an employee or taking other adverse employment action against an employee in retaliation for the employee's good faith complaint about safety and health hazards or other violations of law in the workplace and the environment.

7.16 Labor Disputes

In the event of labor dispute, the employee and Partners Dominican Republic will work to rectify the dispute immediately. In the case that the labor dispute cannot be resolved between the two parties, an arbitration committee shall rule on all disputes concerning anything which is not determined by provisions of laws, regulations, collective agreements or agreements in force, as well as those relating to negotiating and revising the terms of collective agreements.

7.17 Hygiene, Health & Workplace Security

Partners Dominican Republic will take all necessary precautions to effectively protect the life, safety and health of employees. In order to ensure this, Partners Dominican Republic will take the necessary measures that are aimed at:

- Preventing accidents in the workplace;
- Ensuring that all machinery, equipment and other operations have security measures in place and are kept in good condition and will be subject to periodic inspection and maintenance;
- Preventing occupational diseases;
- Preventing fires;
- Providing a healthy and clean work environment;
- Providing the necessary clothing and equipment to ensure appropriate protection;
- Providing security guards for the office as necessary;
- Warning employees of any workplace dangers that could impact their health;
- Carrying out training activities on hygiene and safety at work as needed;
- Ensuring proper hygiene in sanitary facilities;
- Ensuring that appropriate hygiene is maintained in facilities where food or drinks are prepared; and
- Maintaining a first aid kit in the office.

Partners Dominican Republic will comply with the measures indicated by the Dominican Republican Institute of Social Security in order to prevent the occurrence of workplace

accidents and occupational diseases. All employees share the responsibility for workplace safety. The FO Director is responsible for developing safety awareness and ensuring that all operations are performed with regard for the safety and health of all employees involved. Employees are responsible for continuously practicing safety while performing their job duties. Employees are encouraged to be alert to unsafe conditions and report them promptly to the FO Director. All reports can be made without fear of reprisal. The worker may terminate the contract of employment, submitting his resignation, as a result of a serious danger to his safety or health, if the preventive and safety measures established by the laws are not complied with.

7.17.1 Housekeeping

Safety is directly related to neatness and cleanliness. Items that are out of place can cause accidents and injuries, and lack of cleanliness can quickly become a health risk. Furthermore, our office reflects our staff and organization to outside guests, so it is everyone's shared responsibility to project the best impression possible.

Employees are expected to keep their work areas neat, organized, and free of clutter or objects that could interfere with the work process or cause accidents. Employees should assist with keeping public areas presentable by:

- Returning tools and supplies to their proper place and condition after use.
- Properly disposing of trash and cleaning spills or other messes.
- Storing limited food items in the refrigerator, and promptly consuming or removing them.
- Making sure hallways, walkways and other publicly visible areas are free and clear of dangerous obstacles or unsightly objects.
- Reporting safety and maintenance issues immediately.

7.17.2 Job Related Injury Reporting

Employees should immediately report all work-related illnesses, injuries, or occupational disease exposures to the FO Director or Partners HQ. Employee should complete the

Employee Incident Report Form, found in [Annex G](#). Once reported, the FO Director in conjunction with Partners HQ will determine the next steps.

Partners does not discriminate or retaliate against employees who have filed legitimate job-related injury report. Supervisors will not take or threaten any action to compel or persuade employees not a job-related injury report.

8. Recruitment and Labor Contracts

8.1 Application Process for Personnel

After a position is posted and available, the applicant must complete the Application Form for Personnel, template is provided in [Annex H](#). The applicant will then send the complete application to the FO Director. Only the final list of applicants who meet the qualifications will be sent to the supervisor of the position and Partners HQ, whom will proceed with the recruitment process, with support from the FO Director. Note that all recruitment of staff will be internal and/or external.

8.1.1 Internal Recruitment

In order to promote within Partners Dominican Republic as much as possible, the vacant position may be filled by any employee who would be interested and who, after evaluation, meets the requirements for fill the vacancy. If a promotion is made internally, the employee may be eligible for a salary increase and other changes as determined by the new position.

8.1.2 External Recruitment

When external recruitment for a vacancy is needed, the job offer should be actively advertised and promoted locally and internationally. The advertisement should be clear, accurate and brief, but should also provide terms of reference, necessary training and experience, and how to apply. Advertising notices will be brief, clear, and precise and at a minimum provide:

1. Reference terms;
2. Information on the necessary training and experience of the candidate; and

3. Place and deadline for submission of applications

Per Dominican Republican law, any recruitment advertising cannot place requirements on the position that relate to sex, race, ethnicity or marital status of the person.

The FO Director will review all CVs received and the selection criteria will be forwarded to the supervisor of the position and Partners HQ.

8.1.3 Transfer within the Partners Dominican Republic

An employee's transfer means moving from one department to another, to a similar position. The salary remains unchanged. This is not a disciplinary measure. The transfer of an employee is carried out:

1. By decision of the FO Director, when in the interests of Partners Dominican Republic and Partners HQ;
2. At the request of the employee, the case will be considered according to the possibilities within Partners Dominican Republic; and
3. At the request of his immediate supervisor

Any transfer of position requires the decision of the managers of the two (2) departments concerned, FO Director and Partners HQ.

8.1.4 Promotion within the Partners Dominican Republic

Promotion is not automatic. However, following the annual performance evaluation, an exceptional employee may benefit from promotion if there is availability within the organizational structure at Partners Dominican Republic. The promoted employee receives the basic salary corresponding to the new position held, in accordance with the pay grade and category.

When a worker temporarily or definitively occupies a job of greater remuneration than his own, and not a promotion itself, he must receive the salary that corresponds to the first, without implying that he is entitled to improvements or bonuses that due to his special efficiency or length service in the company, could have the person who previously held that position.

8.2 Selection Process for Personnel

Both internal and/or external candidates should be reviewed and interviewed. A selection committee will be organized and must include at a minimum the position's supervisor, FO Director and Partners HQ. It will have two potential phases:

1. An interview of the successful candidates by a selection committee to assess:
 - a. The qualifications of the candidate in relation to the profile of the position to be filled;
 - b. His/her past experience;
 - c. His/her sense of responsibility;
 - d. His/her ability to perform the duties of the position; and
 - e. His/her ability to communicate.
2. A written or practical test (if required) to judge the technical qualifications of the candidate. This will include a matrix for evaluating candidates through a scoring system. This will support the procurement process for selecting the final candidate to fill the position.

Note: some projects will require specific qualification/requirements before hiring any Key Personnel. Any specific donor requirements should be followed when hiring any personnel.

Final candidate's information will be sent to the FO Director and Partners HQ for final approval. Once approved, the candidate will sign his/her contract and be provided with his/her orientation. All offer letters/agreements should, at a minimum, be signed by both the employee and FO Director.

8.3 Employee Definition

The Dominican labor code regulates labor relations, of an individual and collective nature, established between workers and employers or their professional organizations due to the provision of subordinate work. Therefore, under Dominican law, any natural person who provides services, material or intellectual, under the direction and dependence of another is considered to be an employee and is subject to the labor laws.

An independent contractor does not provide services under the direction and dependence of another and is not subject to specific working hours. If an employee is misclassified as an independent contractor, they may bring an action before a labor court to determine whether their relationship constitutes employment and seek the payment of any employment benefits to which they would have been entitled had they been correctly classified as an employee.

8.4 Labor Contract Definition

Dominican labor laws are territorial in nature. Any work carried out on Dominican soil is subject to the provisions of the Labor Code irrespective of the nationality or residence of the parties involved.

8.4.1 Employee Labor Agreements

Any relationship in which one person obliges himself/herself to provide any form of service to another in exchange for remuneration and under the direction or supervision of the latter is considered to be an employment contract and, as such, subject to the provisions of the Labor Code. Furthermore, if a fixed term contract ends, and the individual continues to provide the same services with the employer's knowledge, the contract will be considered as an indefinite period and will be considered an employee from the start of the relationship. For fixed term contracts to give rise to an indefinite contract, it is necessary that they be uninterrupted, that is, that the worker must provide his services every working day, without other suspensions and breaks than those authorized by this Code or those agreed between the parties, and that continuity extends indefinitely.

Per Partners Dominican Republic, individual contracts of employment must be written, and all salary quoted in gross USD. All written work contracts have four (4) originals: one (1) for each of the contracting parties, and the other two (2) will be sent by the employer to the Department of Labor or to the local authority that exercises its functions. The contracts must be sent within the three (3) days of hire. This local authority will file one of the originals, and it will be registered on the books, and then the local authority will send the other original,

within three (3) days of receiving it to the Department of Labor for filing and registration in their office. This includes all new contracts, modifications and/or novation.

All the legally established employee benefits are deemed to be automatically included in any employment contract. The minimum legal terms and conditions of the Dominican labor laws apply by default, unless custom or practice in the workplace, or an applicable collective agreement, includes any other term which improves the employment conditions for the employee. Employees cannot waive any rights that would lessen their benefits under the Labor Code. Any such waiver is automatically considered null and void.

8.4.2 Contractor Agreements

A private contractor agreement may be considered an employment contract if the elements of direction or supervision by one party over the other is present. The Labor Code expressly states as a fundamental principle that the terms of the employment contract are those that reflect the real facts and circumstances of the relationship between the parties, and not necessarily those contained in a written contract.

8.5 Types of Labor Contracts

There is no restriction on the duration of any employment contract. The contract may be executed for an indefinite or a fixed period. The general rule is that employment contracts are executed for an indefinite period. Additionally, all work which is permanent in nature, should be formed for an indefinite period of time.

Below are the options for labor contracts at Partners Dominican Republic:

- Fixed-term/Temporary contract -The fixed-term contract is the one which term is fixed in advance by the will of the parties. These contracts are legally considered to be an exception (as indefinite term contracts are the norm) and may only be executed in the following situations, per article 31 and 33 of the Labor Code:
 - To provide a service or perform a work which in its nature is of limited duration;

- To substitute an employee on leave, on vacation, or due to temporary impediment; and
- If a fixed term contract furthers the interests of the employee.

There is no legally established limit to the duration of fixed-term contracts or period after which the employee is deemed to be permanent. However, when an employee continues to render services for an employer beyond the date of termination, the contract shall be considered of indefinite duration as from the initial date per articles 31, 34, 35 and 73 of the Labor Code. Essentially the renewal of the contract turns the contract into one of an indefinite duration.

- Open-ended/Permanent contract - The open-ended contract is one whose term is not provided for in advance and which can cease at any moment by the will of the worker or the employer, without prejudice to the legal provisions regulating the termination of the contract of employment. A contract of a temporary nature which is tacitly renewed shall be regarded as having been transformed into a contract of indefinite duration, granting the worker all the benefits and legal advantages attached to it.

8.5.1 Payment Structure for Labor Contracts

Upon the creation of an employment opportunity, the FO Director must determine what type of payment structure for the labor contract will be needed, based on the work performed. The following types of payments options are available:

- Fixed Price – Fixed Price consultant agreements are used mainly for assignments in which the content and length of the services and the required output of the worker are precisely specific and for these reasons the worker can generally control the scope of work and duration of services. Under a fixed price agreement Partners Dominican Republic agrees to pay the worker a predetermined set amount of money for certain products of specified technical natures, such as reports, project designs, etc. that is to be delivered within a specified deadline, the quality of which can usually be readily assessed. Fixed-price agreements provides for a price that is not subject to any

adjustment based on the worker's cost experience in performing the contract. It provides maximum incentive for the worker to control costs and perform effectively.

- Time- Based (Hourly, Weekly, Monthly, etc.) – In a time, based agreement, the worker provides services at a pre-determined time-based unit rate and records all hours worked under the scope of work. Time based labor agreements are recommended when the nature and scope of the services provided are such that a scope of work is general guidelines for the activities to be performed and when it becomes difficult to determine the exact time with sufficient precision, which is common in complex scope of works.

8.5.2 Pay Structure

All permanent staff members of the organization, except for consultants, are paid according to the salary schedule of Partners Dominican Republic.

Each position in a category is based on a combination of:

- a) Level of responsibility
- b) Qualifications required for this position

8.6 Content of Labor Contracts

Each labor contract must include at a minimum the following elements:

- Names and surnames;
- Age;
- Sex;
- Marital status;
- Nationality;
- Domicile and residence of the contracting parties;
- Numbers of national ID card for both contracting parties;
- Date of the initiation of the employment relationship;

- Indication of the services that the worker is obliged to provide or the nature of the work to be executed, specifying if possible, the characteristics and conditions of the job;
- Place or places where services should be provided;
- Duration of the contract as either an indefinite time period, or a fixed term, and the indication of the work or service that is the object of the contract, if it is for a specific work or service;
- Working hours and work schedule;
- Salary, benefits, and/or commission (per unit of time, per unit of work or in any other way) including the form of payment, the time period for payment and the place payment will be issued;
- Other legal provisions based on the parties' agreement;
- Places and date of the binding of the contract; and
- Signatures of the contracting parties. The worker or employer who does not know or cannot sign will supply his signature validly by setting his digital signs in the contract.

8.7 Obligations of Binding Labor Contract

Per a legal labor contract, below are the obligations and prohibitions of each contracting party. In general, for both parties, the employment contract binds to what is expressly agreed and all the consequences that are in accordance with good faith, equity, use or the law.

The workers' obligations are as follows:

- Attend work on time, and provide the employer the agreed upon services in the manner agreed upon;
- Observe good behavior and strict discipline during working hours;
- Comply with the working hours in the workplace and observe the legal or regulatory provisions regarding work;
- Perform the work with efficiency, care, diligence; dedication and in the appropriate manner;

- Save unused materials and preserve in good condition the instruments and tools that are used during work. Note: employees are not responsible for normal deterioration or issues that occur by chance, force majeure, poor quality or defective construction;
- Keep his/her boss informed of possible defects in materials which could cause damage to the company;
- Treat his/her boss and fellow workers with respect;
- Obey the instructions, orders and instructions of the employer or person in charge of the work;
- Provide the necessary assistance in case of an accident;
- Not to disclose secrets of Partners, neither to compete with and be loyal to the employer;
- Strictly observe the measures in place that protect the employee's security and that of their co-workers, and the security of the places where work is performed;
- Indemnify the employer for all damage caused by his own fault to premises, raw materials and tools; and
- Fulfill all other obligations that would be specifically stipulated in the contract.

The workers' prohibitions are as follows:

- Leave work during normal work hours without a justified cause or without supervisor approval;
- Promote political or religious propaganda in the workplace;
- Take up collections in the workplace, during work hours;
- Work while intoxicated or under the influence of narcotic drugs or in any other similar condition;
- Use tools or equipment provided by the employer for any other objective than as normally designated in the course of work;
- Extract raw or processed material, without the permission of the employer;

- Carry weapons of any kind during work hours in the workplace, except in special cases duly authorized by the laws, or in the case of sharp instruments which are required due to the nature of work; and
- Any act that violates or attempts to sabotage the work.

Partners Dominican Republic obligations are as follows:

- Provide a safe and secure work environment for employees;
- Keep offices and other places of work in the proper sanitary condition;
- Install a first aid kit, which is available to all employees;
- Maintain a secure area for workers to leave their tools and instructions and other necessary materials for work;
- Provide workers with preventives medicine free of charge as indicated by health authorities under the law, in case of epidemic diseases;
- Provide employee's a fair salary, professional training and respect for their physical integrity, intimacy and personal dignity;
- Determine, through internal rules, the working conditions and bring them to the worker's attention;
- Provide the worker with suitable work premises and tools in the required hygiene, safety and operating conditions;
- Pay the worker the salary corresponding to the time he/she loses when he is unable to work due to the fault of the employer;
- Pay to the worker in full and on the due date the remuneration provided for in the contract, after deduction of any legal and contractual charge for the repayment of loans, advances, proven losses and damages affecting the employer's revenues, property or facilities;
- Provide 12 monthly salaries per year, plus any overtime, and a Christmas bonus.
- Provide severance pay in cases of dismissal without just cause;
- Provide marriage leave, bereavement leave, maternity leave; paternity leave (where applicable);

- Treat the worker with respect, being careful not to inflict any verbal or de facto maltreatment; and
- Fulfill all the other obligations stipulated in the contract.

Partners Dominican Republic prohibitions are as follows:

- Induce or require the workers to buy or consume the company goods or services;
- Demand or accept money or other compensation as means to receiving promotions, bonuses, or other improved working conditions or privileges;
- Forcing or attempting to force an employee to withdraw from unions or legal groups to which they belong, or enter the union or group in order to influence the outcomes;
- Pressure workers to vote for a certain candidacy in the election of officials or union representatives;
- Influence the employee's political decisions or religious convictions;
- Appropriating or retaining, by their own will, the tools or objects of the employee, by way of compensation, guarantee or compensation;
- Make or authorize mandatory enrollments for employees, except those required by the law;
- Direct or allow work to be conducted in a state of drunkenness or under the influence of narcotic drugs or in any other abnormal similar condition;
- Exercise actions against the worker that may be considered sexual harassment, or support or not intervene in cases of harassment done by representatives of the employer; and
- Any other act that prohibits or restricts any employee right that is protected by law.

8.8 Termination & Suspension of Labor Contract

Labor contracts may be terminated entirely or suspended for a period in certain circumstances and may affect all or some employees. The effects of suspension does not imply termination of the employment contract or responsibility on behalf of either party. During the suspension of a contract, the worker is released from providing their services and

the employer is subsequently released from providing the agreed compensation, unless contrary to law, the collective agreement or the contract.

8.8.1 Temporary Suspension of Labor Contract without Liability for the Parties

An employment contract may be suspended by mutual consent or due to one of the other causes stated in the Labor Code. Under a suspended employment contract, neither employer nor employee have to comply with their respective obligations for the duration of the suspension. It is the worker's obligation to give notice to the employer of the cause that prevents him/her from attending his work within twenty-four hours that justifies contract suspension. The Dominican Republic Labor Code states the following are causes for labor contract suspensions:

- Maternity leave for working women, according to the provisions of article 236;
- Employee is complying with legal obligations, and as such is unable to provide his/her services to the employer;
- Detention, arrest or preventive detention of the worker, whether or not followed by provisional release, until the date that the final sentence is irrevocable, provided it is acquitted or download or condemn it only just pecuniary, without prejudice to the provisions of article 88;
- Lack of raw materials to continue working that is not attributable to the employer;
- Lack of funds for the normal continuation of work, if the employer fully justifies the impossibility of get funds;
- A legally declared strike, the cause of which is not considered by labor courts to be attributable to the employer;
- Unpaid leave or breaks as agreed upon in writing between the employer and employee;
- Excess production in relation to the economic situation of the company and market conditions;
- A contagious illness of the employee or any other employee that temporarily makes it impossible for the performance of other employee's work;

- Diseases, occupational hazards, required leave under the law; pre and postnatal breaks and other issues that produce temporary disability which inhibits the ability to perform work; and
- The unaffordability of the exploitation of the company;
- Accidents that occur to the worker under the conditions and circumstances foreseen and protected by the Law on Work Accidents, and when the disability is temporary;
- Force majeure or fortuitous event, resulting in an immediate but temporary stoppage of work (e.g. natural disasters, accidents involving office or materials, fire, etc.).

The suspension of the employment contract will take effect from the day the event that originated it occurred. The suspension ceases with the cause that has motivated it. The employer will immediately notify the Department of Labor or to the local authority that exercises its functions, who will be in charge of informing the employees, in addition to any notification provided by the employer. If the employer does not resume work, despite having ceased what caused the suspension, the Department of Labor, after review of the circumstance, will declare that the effects of the suspension have ceased. If the employee does not return to work within six (6) days of receiving notification that work has resumed, then the employee is at fault and is considered as resigned. The contract will then be termination by the employer.

8.8.2 Termination of Labor Contract

Termination implies a permanent break in the employment contract. Several types of termination are contemplated under the Dominican Labor Code. The law requires that all salaries, bonuses and other applicable employee benefits must be paid to the employee up to the date of their termination, whether the termination is with or without cause.

There are a few exceptions in which termination is not legally possible without Labor authorities' prior authorization, as the law provide special protections. These exceptions include dismissal of pregnant or employees who have recently given birth.

- “At will” termination by the employer is strictly forbidden during the pregnancy of the employee and up to three (3) months after the birth of her child.

- An employer cannot dismiss an employee for cause (despido) during her pregnancy nor six (6) months after childbirth without the prior authorization of the labor authorities. Noncompliance is penalized with the equivalent of five (5) months' salary, in addition to the standard severance payment indicated in [Section 8.12 Statutory Benefits – Severance Pay](#).

There are 3 (three) ways in which a labor contract can be terminated.

1) *As a matter of law*; without the need for legal proceedings or a court decision.

- Completion of work in the case of contracts concluded for a specific work
- Expiry of the period laid down in the contract
- Due to the impossibility of execution
- Grounds for termination expressly stipulated in the contract
- Duly proven case of force majeure
- Death or incapacity of the employee
- Complete and final closure as a result of the death of the employer

The automatic termination of the individual contract of labor shall entail no liability for the contracting parties in the first five bullets only. The last bullet remains subject to the legal provisions and may require severance. In the event of death or incapacity of the employee, the employer is required to pay economic assistance to the employee or his/her heirs in accordance with [Section 8.13 Statutory Benefits – Economic Assistance](#).

2) *By mutual consent of the parties* - The cancellation must be confirmed in writing.

The termination of the employment contract by mutual consent, to be valid, must be made before the Department of Labor or the local authority that exercises its functions, or before a Notary, per article 71. There shall be no liability for either party following the termination of the individual labor contract by mutual consent.

3) *By the will of one of the parties*

At Will Termination – “Desahucio”: Any party to an employment contract has the right to terminate it unilaterally without having to specify a cause. The party that terminates the employment contract must give an advance notice to the other party in accordance with [Section 8.11 Mandatory Notices for Termination of Labor Contract](#). Employers who exercise their right to terminate their employees without cause must make severance payments to the terminated employee in accordance with [Section 8.12 Statutory Benefits – Severance Pay](#).

For Cause Termination by the Employee “Dimisión”: An employee who wishes to terminate his/her labor contract without any liability for himself/herself shall inform FO Director or Partners HQ and the Department of Labor on one of the following grounds:

- If the employee was misled by the employer, when the entering into the contract, regarding its conditions;
- If the employer fails to pay the full salary in the manner and place agreed or determined by the law, except for the reductions authorized;
- If the employer refuses to pay salary or resume work in case of illegal suspension of work;
- If the employer has acted with lack of integrity and honor and has committed slander, insults, bad treatment, or acts or attempted acts of violence against the employee or his/her family;
- If the employee suffers from the aforementioned acts, off-duty, and therefore due to the severity in nature, the employee is unable to fulfill the contract;
- If the employer, by itself or through another person, hid or intentionally impaired the tools of the employee;
- If the employer illegally reduces the employee’s salary;

- If the employer requires the employee to perform a job different from what is agreed to within the contract, unless there is an emergency case and there is no change in pay;
- If the employee is required to move his/her residence in order to fulfill his/her work and it was not contractually agreed to;
- If employee is in the presence of persons carrying contagious diseases and the employee is to remain in immediate contact with the affected person;
- Threat to the safety or health of the worker due to lack of hygienic conditions in the workplace or failure to comply with preventive and safety measures prescribed by law;
- If the employer acts recklessly, carelessly or inexcusably regarding the safety conditions of the workplace;
- If the employer violates any rights [8.7 Obligations of Binding Labor Contract](#);
- Breach of obligations imposed on the employer by contract or by law.

Resignation: If an employee decides to voluntarily terminate the work relationship; he/she must notify the employer beforehand in writing. The notice must be given in accordance with the rules established in the Labor Code and in [Section 8.11 Mandatory Notices for Termination of Labor Contract](#).

For Cause Termination by the Employer “Despido”: Partners Dominican Republic if wishing to terminate the labor contract of an employee without liability must prove, provide notice, and terminate based on one of the for-cause termination reasons as outlined in the Labor Code article 88:

1. If the worker deceived the employer by means of false letters of recommendation or certificates when the contract was concluded;

2. If the employee executes his tasks in a way that demonstrates his inability and inefficiency. This cause is only valid for the first three months of service, after which it cannot be used;
3. If the employee has acted with lack of integrity and honor during the execution of tasks and has incurred in slander, acts of violence and mistreatment against the employer or the relatives of the latter who are under his watch;
4. If the employee commits any of the aforementioned acts against one of his fellow co-workers, causing an alteration to the workplace's order;
5. If during non-working hours the employee commits any of the acts mentioned in above in number three (3) against the employer, relatives or the top officials of the company;
6. If the employee willingly causes material losses during the execution of tasks or as a consequence of it to the buildings, machinery, constructions, equipment, raw materials, products and any other objects related to their works;
7. If the employee causes the serious damage mentioned above in number six (6) unwillingly, but with negligence or recklessness;
8. If the employee commits acts of dishonesty in the workplace;
9. If the employee reveals manufacturing secrets or exposes confidential matters to the detriment of the company;
10. If the employee carelessly or recklessly jeopardizes the security of the workshop, workplace or of the people inside them;
11. If the employee does not attend work during two (2) consecutive days or two (2) days in the same month without the due authorization from the employer or his representative, or without notifying the cause in the term established under the Labor Code, article 58 (within the 24 hours);

12. If the employee is absent from work, does not notify the cause and is in charge of a task or machinery that if stalled, necessarily implies a disturbance to the company;
13. If the employee exits the workplace during working hours without an authorization from the employer or his representative and without previously notifying the employer or his representative the reasons for leaving the workplace;
14. If the employee disobeys the employer or his representatives, provided that the disobedience is related to the service provided;
15. If the employee refuses to adopt preventive measures or follow procedures established by law, the competent authorities or the employer, in order to avoid accidents or illnesses;
16. If the employee violates any of the provisions established under numerals 1, 2, 5 or 6 of article 45;
17. If the employee violates any of the provisions established under numeral 3 and 4 of article 45 after the Labour Department, at the requirement of the employer, has issued warnings for committing the same error;
18. If the employee has been sentenced to prison by irrevocable judgment;
19. If the employee lacks commitment in the execution of the tasks he has been hired for and/or fails to comply any other obligations established under the employment agreement.

Termination without Cause: If Partners Dominican Republic terminates the for any reason that differs from what is established by law or agreement, the Employer must pay the Employee payments established by the Labor Code that is in force, such as severance for time served and proportional labor benefits (i.e. Annual leave).

8.8.3 Work Certificate upon Termination

Upon the expiration of any labor contract, for any reason, the employer must give the employee a document that states the following:

- Start and end date;
- Type of work performed;
- Normal and overtime salary earned.

If the employee prefers, the work certification can also include the following:

- Information on the quality or way work was performed; and
- The cause(s) for termination

8.9 Probation Period 90 Days

All new employees are subject to a probationary period of 90 days. During this trial period he/she may terminate his/her services without notice. One week before the end of the probationary period, the candidate will be evaluated and if he/she does not meet the requirements of the position he/she may be terminated at the end of his/her probation, without notice, but he/she will be entitled to the Bonus and leave proportional to the number months of service and will be compensated for all time worked.

During the probation period, the employer or employee can terminate the contract, with or without just cause, and without incurring any penalties or liabilities. Once the trial period expires, if the employment continues, all the statutory rights automatically apply to the employment contract.

8.10 Obligated Labor Poster

In accordance with Article 159 of the Labor Code, Partners Dominican Republic is obligated to place a poster in a visible place in its establishment, which is sealed by the local labor authority and includes the following:

- Normal starting and ending hours
- Intermediate periods of rest
- Weekly rest days

8.11 Mandatory Notices for Termination of Labor Contract

The employer or the employee who wishes to terminate a written labor contract must first give written notice to the other party.

8.11.1 Mandatory Notices for Termination – Employer Responsibility

At Will Termination “Desahucio”: The employer who wishes to unilaterally terminate a labor contract without having a specific cause (at will) must first give written notice to the employee, per the Labor Code article 75. The required notices are below based on length of service:

Service Period	Notice Period
From 3 to 6 months	7 Days
From 6 months to 12 months	14 Days
More than 12 months	28 Days

If the employer omits the notice, he must pay the employee a substitute compensation equivalent to the remuneration that would correspond to the employee’s regular salary earned during the applicable minimum period for the advance notice. During the notice period, the employee will have the right, without a reduction in salary, to enjoy a two half-day leave per week.

For Cause Termination by the Employer “Despido”: Employers may dismiss their employees alleging one or several of the specific causes listed in the Dominican Republic Labor Code article 88. For cause termination by an employer requires evidence of one or several of the listed grounds for termination. Additionally, it requires that the employer give notice of the termination and the grounds on which it is based to the Department of Labor within 48 hours of the dismissal, per the Labor Code article 91. The right of the employer to base the dismissal on a specific cause for termination expires 15 days after the employee has committed the act alleged as grounds for termination per the Labor Code article 90. Failure to prove cause or

to render the notice within the stated 48 hours will make the employer liable for payment to the employee of severance pay in accordance with [Section 8.12 Statutory Benefits – Severance Pay](#).

8.11.2 Mandatory Notices for Termination – Employee Responsibility

At Will Termination “Desahucio”: The employee who wishes to unilaterally terminate the labor contract without having a specific cause (at will) must first give notice to the other party. This communication can be made orally or in writing. The required notices are below based on length of service:

Service Period	Notice Period
From 3 to 6 months	7 Days
From 6 months to 12 months	14 Days
More than 12 months	28 Days

Furthermore, employees’ contracts that end due to retirement will receive the compensation equivalent to the benefits corresponding to the termination, if the pension is granted by the Dominican Social Security Institute. The pensions or pensions granted by private sector entities and the compensation established in this article are mutually exclusive. The worker can take advantage of one or the other option. If the pension or private retirement is contributory, the worker who opts for compensation will receive part of their contributions stipulated in the retirement plan.

For Cause Termination by the Employee “Dimisión”: An employee may resign from his or her job for cause. For cause termination by employees requires evidence of one or several of the listed grounds for termination. It also requires that the employee give notice of the termination and the grounds on which it is based to the Department of Labor within 48 hours of the resignation. The right of the employee to base the dismissal on a specific cause for

termination expires 15 days after the employer has committed the act alleged as grounds for termination.

If the ground for termination is proven, the employee has the right to receive severance pay in accordance with [Section 8.12 Statutory Benefits – Severance Pay](#).

8.12 Statutory Benefits – Severance Pay

For Cause Termination by the Employer (“Despido”): For cause termination by an employer requires evidence of one or several of the listed grounds for the basis of termination, which must be sent to the Department of Labor within 48 hours of the dismissal. Failure to prove cause or to render the notice within the stated 48 hours will make the employer liable for payment to the employee of severance pay as indicated below. If the cause is proved and notice rendered, then no severance pay is required from Partners Dominican Republic.

For Cause Termination by the Employee “Dimisión”: For cause termination by an employee requires evidence of one or several of the listed grounds for the basis of termination, which must be sent to the Department of Labor within 48 hours of the resignation. If the ground for termination is proven, the employee has the right to receive severance pay as outlined below.

At Will Termination “Desahucio”: If Partners Dominican Republic terminates employees without cause or “at will”, the organization must make severance payments to the terminated employee as detailed below:

Service Period	Severance Pay
From 3 to 6 months	6 Days Salary
From 6 months to 1 year	13 Days Salary
From 1 year to 5 years	21 Days Salary per year of employment
More than 5 years	23 Days Salary per year of employment

Severance must be paid to the employee within 10 days of the termination; otherwise, the employer will have to pay a penalty of one day's salary for every day of delay.

Resignation Without Cause: Severance pay does not apply if the employee terminates the contract voluntarily without cause, except in the case where he fails to notify his resignation at the time of notice indicated before.

Unfair or Unjustified Dismissal: In accordance with article 87 of the Labor Code, unjustified dismissal occurs when no just cause can be proved by the employer. In this case the employer is obliged to pay: 1) the prior notice, 2) severance indemnity, and 3) back pay as from the date of the claim until court's decision, with a ceiling of 6 months' salary per article 95 of the Labor Code. However, under the Labor Code, the employer can always dismiss an employee "at will" or without cause (desahucio), provided prior notice is respected and severance payment is paid per article 75 and 76 of the Labor Code. Thus, termination on personal grounds and redundancy is always possible. Note, two (2) months is the maximum time period to claim for unfair dismissal, after which date it is no longer possible.

8.13 Statutory Benefits – Economic Assistance

In the following events employers must pay the employee or his/her heirs economic assistance.

- For the death of the employer or his/her physical or mental disability, provided that these facts produce as a consequence the business termination;
- For the death of the employee or his/her physical or mental disability or inability to perform the services that were forced to lend. In this case, the economic assistance will be paid to the person that the employee has designated in declaration made before the Department of Labor or the authority local that exercises its functions, or before a Notary. In the absence of this statement, the right will belong equally entitled to the spouse and minor children of the employer. If the employee is physically or mentally disabled and not able to receive payment his/her rights, financial assistance will be made to the person cares for the employee;

- Due to worker's illness or absence complying with the obligations referred to in the Labor Code ordinal 3rd. of article 51 or another justified cause that prevented him from attending his/her work for a total period of one year, from the day of the first absence;
- Due to bankruptcy of the company, provided that the exploitation of the business or for its closure or definitive reduction of its staff, resulting from lack of elements to continue exploitation, unsustainability of the same or another cause similar, with the approval of the Department of Labor, in the form established in article 56;
- Due to the depletion of the raw material object of an extractive industry.

The amount of economic assistance is as follows:

Service Period	Amount of Economic Assistance
From 3 to 6 months	5 Days Salary
From 6 months to 12 months	10 Days Salary
More than 12 months	15 Days Salary per year of employment

8.14 Record Keeping for Personnel

Partners Dominican Republic requires that all documentation related to the solicitation, hiring, review and termination of employees be retained in secure personnel folders. These folders should all reprimands, warnings and suspensions of each for each employee with dates and reasons. Any required documents/provisions from the donor should also be included in the personnel record. Individual personnel folders/files should be maintained for all employees. All information provided by the employee is, and remains, confidential, and the documents in his/her file may not in any way be accessed by unauthorized personnel.

For each Partners Dominican Republic staff member there will be an individual file which will include:

- 1) The Vitae curriculum;

- 2) A copy of the certificates and diplomas mentioned in the CV;
- 3) The job application form;
- 4) The employment contract;
- 5) The job description;
- 6) Any documentation indicating a salary increase;
- 7) The Employee Evaluation Forms;
- 8) Any document relating to a change in position, transfer or promotion;
- 9) Any offer letters or warning letters; and
- 10) Record of paid leave or any other special leave requested and obtained
- 11) All documents related to:
 - a) Resignation
 - b) Revocation
 - c) Lay-off
 - d) Other causes of separation.

The Partners Dominican Republic reserves the right to verify the authenticity of any document submitted by the Employee.

8.14.1 Access to Personnel Records

The only individuals at Partners Dominican Republic, who have access to the personnel files, are FO Director, the Administrative and Financial Director. Employees will not be allowed to access or review their personnel files, however, upon special authorization and approval from FO Director, the employee may review their file. This review must be done in the presence of FO Director.

9. Worktime, Workdays and Holidays

9.1 Normal Daytime Work Hours

Work hours are time when the worker is available to the employers. Rest periods are time when the worker is not available for the employer's work.

Daytime work hours range from 7:00AM to 9:00PM. A work shift is considered a mixed shift as long as the night period is less than three (3) hours, otherwise it is considered a night shift. Normal working hours may not exceed eight (8) hours a day nor 44 hours a week. Employees in executive or managerial positions are exempted from this rule and may work up to 10 hours a day. All hours worked in excess of normal agreed work hours are overtime, however, managers are exempt from overtime pay. Under no circumstances can the employee be required to work more than 10 hours in a workday.

Partners Dominican Republic observes the following working days and hours: Monday to Friday from 9AM to 5PM, or 40 hours of work per week.

9.2 Nighttime Work

Nighttime work is between 9:00PM of one day and 7:00AM of the next day. Nighttime hours are compensated at a 15% surcharge. Therefore, all nighttime hours therefore are compensated at 1.15 times the hourly salary.

9.3 Overtime and Limitations

Overtime refers to any hours worked beyond normal working hours listed above. Note, overtime pay does not apply to managers. All work effectively done outside of normal work hours constitutes overtime work and must be paid as such. Overtime hours up to 68 hours are compensated with an additional 35% surcharge. All overtime hours up to 68 hours therefore are compensated at 1.35 times the hourly salary. Hours worked in excess of 68 hours a week are paid at a 100% premium, therefore these hours are compensated at 2 times the hourly salary. Overtime hours cannot exceed 80 hours in a quarter. However, Partners Dominican Republic believes that the daily work assigned to its employees can be done as part of her/her regular schedule. Therefore, except in case of emergency or force majeure,

all overtime must be approved by the supervisor. An employee requesting overtime must obtain the approval of his/her supervisor prior to overtime hours being worked. Any overtime worked without supervisor approval will be paid, however disciplinary action will be taken including up to termination. Overtime is not considered as necessary because of the slowness of an employee in the performance of his/her duties, whether it is the improper performance of duties and/or the obligation to seek or correct errors.

9.4 Rest and Break Time

Below is the list of rest and break times allotted to all employees at Partners Dominican Republic, in accordance with Dominican Republic law:

- Half-Time Break - the worker has a right to a rest break of at least half an hour within the working time, which must be counted as paid working time.
- Break for Pregnant Women - During the period of apparent pregnancy, the woman shall be entitled to two rest periods per day of at least half an hour each, in addition to the half-time rest for the meal. Prenatal breaks will be extended according to your physical conditions, by medical prescription. These moments of rest are paid.
- Breastfeeding Break - Any mother after the birth of her child is entitled to three (3) rest periods per day of 20 minutes each to breastfeed, in addition to the half-time rest for the meal. These moments of rest are paid.
- Pediatrician Break - Any mother during the first year after the birth of her child is entitled to a half-day each month for their child can be seen by a doctor/pediatrician. This moment of rest is paid.

9.5 Weekly Rest

Every worker has the right to enjoy a paid rest day after each week, regardless of the number of hours worked during this period. This day of rest includes at least thirty-six (36) consecutive hours of uninterrupted rest. Payment is made based on the daily wage for workers with a fixed salary. If an employee is required to work during his/her weekly period of rest, he/she is entitled to receive a 100% premium on his/her salary for his/her work during that time or given compensatory time off the following week.

9.5.1 Compensatory Time for Weekly Rest

In the rare event that an employee of Partners Dominican Republic is required to work during his/her weekly rest of thirty-six (36) hours, the employee will be provided compensatory time in the following week in lieu of a 100% premium on his/her salary for the time worked during the weekly rest. This compensatory time provided will be equivalent to the hours worked during the weekly rest.

9.6 Holidays

All employees at the Partners Dominican Republic will be granted the following non-working holidays in accordance with local Dominican Republic law. If an employee must work on a holiday, the employee is paid a 50% surcharge, not including the increase for overtime, or payment of weekly rest. Additional paid holidays may be granted at the discretion of Partners HQ.

The legal holidays in Dominican Republic are:

- January 1st - New Year's Day
- January 6th – Epiphany/Day of Kings
- January 21st – Day of La Altagracia
- January 26th – Juan Pablo Duarte Day
- Good Friday (Friday before Easter)
- Easter Day (Sunday)
- May 1st - Labor Day
- Corpus Christi Day
- August 16th – Restoration Day
- September 24th – Our Lady of Las Mercedes Day
- November 6th - Constitution Day
- December 25th - Christmas Day

10. Wages and Social Benefits

10.1 Wages

All employees will be remunerated for work provided to Partners Dominican Republic. This wage or salary can be paid per unit of time, per piece work or it can be fixed.

In order to receive remuneration for time worked, all employees will need to complete timesheets. Time records are legal documents and the basic source of information for payroll purposes; therefore, time worked must be reflected accurately and in accordance with the [Section 10.3 Timekeeping](#). All staff is responsible for approving their timesheet to certify the accuracy of all time recorded. Each supervisor will review for accuracy and approve the time sheets after the employee submits. Remuneration to all employees will be based on the approved timesheets only. All tax and other required deductions as mandated by local law will be withheld from each paycheck.

Salaries will be paid no later than the last working day of each month by bank transfer.

10.2 Wage & Leave Advances

No wage or salary advances are allowed. Payroll is issued after the hours worked are completed and done. Furthermore, no advance leave for vacation, sick, or other leave may be taken.

10.3 Timekeeping

In order to ensure accurate timekeeping in the field, Partners HQ will require use of the electronic timekeeping and accrual platform called Replicon. Each employee will be responsible for utilizing his/her account to accurately record hours worked and request all types of leave. At the end of each week, employee will be responsible for reviewing and certifying their hours worked by clicking “submit” timesheet in Replicon. Subsequently, the respective employee’s supervisor will need to log in and review and approve of the hours worked and click “submit.” All timesheets will not be considered completed until both the employee and the supervisor have certified the timesheet. Monthly, all timesheets should be printed and filed in accordance with [4.2 Filing and Records](#).

Any leave that is not requested and recorded in Replicon correctly will be disallowed and not approved. Failure to accurately report time and/or leave requests can result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

10.4 Pay Slips (Paystubs)

All employees should receive a pay slip with their salary payment (regardless of method of payment) that documents the details of the payment. Pay slips should include the following information:

1. Name of employee
2. Period to which the payment applies
3. Units, rate, and extended amount of gross salary or wage payments
4. Units, rate, extended amount and description for each additional category of pay
5. Units, rate, extended amount and description for each deduction
6. Taxes withheld on behalf of the government or other taxation authority
7. Subtotaled net pay amount

The pay slips are completed using information from the reviewed and approved monthly payroll timesheets.

10.5 Bonuses & Benefits

10.5.1 13th Month Bonus

Partners Dominican Republic must pay their employees a 13th Month or “Aguinaldo” (Christmas Bonus) before December 20th of each year, equal to one-twelfth (1/12) of the total regular salary earned during the year. For the calculation of the bonus, regular salary excludes tips, overtime and benefits received from profit sharing (if applicable). If the employee did not work for the entire period, the bonus must be paid proportionately to the time worked. This bonus is exempt from ISR which is income tax.

10.5.2 Health Insurance

Health insurance is provided to all Partners Dominican Republic staff and 100% paid by Partners Dominican Republic. Dependents may be eligible for coverage but are 100% the responsibility of the employee.

10.6 Wage Deductions

A deduction is any withholding from an employee's salary payment made by Partners Dominican Republic.

10.6.1 Statutory Deductions

The following deductions are mandated by Dominican Republic law to be withheld from all remuneration payments and paid into the Dominican Republic government monthly:

Regular Salary Payments:

- ISR: Income Tax
 - All employment income is taxable. This income includes salary, bonuses, premiums, commissions and allowances.
 - Income tax of residents is calculated by applying a progressive tax rate schedule to taxable income as follows:

Taxable Income (DOP)	Tax Rate on Income Level
Up to 330,301	0%
330,301.01 – 495,450	15%
495,450.01 – 688,125	20%
Over 688,125.01	25%

Note: Rates will be updated in accordance with Dominican Republic law as required. For most updated rates, reference the website of Direccion General de Impuestos Internos <https://dgi.gov.do/>.

- The tax will be withheld monthly by the employer, and subsequently paid into the Direccion General de Impuestos Internos (DGII) by the 3rd day of the following month.

- Seguro Familiar de Salud (SFS) - Health Insurance
 - The total contribution amount is 10.13%, of which the employee contributes 7.09% and the employer contributes 3.04%.
 - The tax will be withheld monthly by the employer, and subsequently paid into the tax administration by the 3rd day of the following month.
- Seguro de Riesgos Laborales (SRL) - Risk Insurance
 - The total contribution amount is 1.10%, of which the employer pays the entire amount.
 - The tax will be withheld monthly by the employer, and subsequently paid into the tax administration by the 3rd day of the following month.
- Seguro de Pensión (SVDS) - Incapacity/Retirement (Pension) Fund
 - The total contribution amount is 9.97%, of which the employee contributes 7.10% and the employer contributes 2.87%.
 - The tax will be withheld monthly by the employer, and subsequently paid into the tax administration by the 3rd day of the following month.
- Instituto de Formación Técnico Profesional (INFOTEP)
 - INFOTEP provides training and continuous education to Dominican workers.
 - The total contribution amount is 1.00%, of which the employer pays the entire amount.
 - The tax will be withheld monthly by the employer, and subsequently paid into the tax administration by the 3rd day of the following month.

In general, the following is exempt from income tax (ISR):

- 13th Month or “Aguinaldo” (Christmas bonus)
- Severance
- Economic Assistance
- Compensation for omission of require notice for termination of a labor contract

10.6.2 Other Deductions

The salary may be subject to these deductions:

- Those authorized by law;
- Those related to workers union dues, prior written authorization of the worker;
- Wage advances made by the employer;
- Those related to loans granted by banking institutions with the recommendation and guarantee of the employer. For this concept, no more than one sixth of the monthly salary received by the workers may be deducted;
- Those related to the worker's contributions to private pension plans.

10.7 Paid Leave

All employees will be entitled to the following paid leave, in addition to all the holidays mentioned above.

10.7.1 Annual Leave

All employees are entitled, after one year of service, to a paid leave of at least 14 working days. Each month, 1.16 days of paid leave will be accrued. For an employee with less than one year of service, the number of annual vacation days = the number of months of service x 1.16. For employees with five (5) or more years of service, paid leave of 18 working days is provided. For these employees, each month 1 ½ days (1.5 days) of leave is accrued. The vacations must be provided, and the employer cannot compensate for this benefit in another manner, except upon termination. Workers must enjoy their vacations within six months of the date of acquisition of the right. On January 1st of each year, the annual leave accrual balance will reset. The maximum carry over value is up to five (5) days of annual leave. Any days above five (5) days will be forfeited.

Employees cannot accrue vacation periods year by year with the purpose of receiving a longer vacation period afterwards. Vacations cannot be fractioned for periods shorter than a week. Labor law provides that all employees must receive the complete, uninterrupted vacation period, meaning that the employer cannot ask an employee to suspend it.

Furthermore, any agreement to relinquish the right to an annual holiday with pay or to forgo such a holiday shall be void.

Non-working holidays and interruptions of work due to sickness or maternity benefiting the worker shall not be deducted from the 14 or 18 working days of annual leave. All annual leave requests must be tracked and recorded properly on the employee's timesheets.

An employee who, after two days of ending his/her annual leave does not show up for his position without just cause, is considered to have resigned.

10.7.1.1 Annual Leave Payout upon Termination

In case of suspension, dismissal or resignation of the employee for any reason before the expiration of his year of service, and whatever the duration of employment, the worker is entitled to payment of his/her portion of annual leave. Employees are entitled to the number of days of regular annual leave accumulated up to the date of termination. The calculation of this payment will be based on the daily average of wages earned during the last twelve months.

10.7.2 Sick Leave

All employees are entitled to a total of 10 days of sick leave per year without a reduction in salary. Each month, .833 days of paid sick leave will be accrued. If the employee does not have one year of service, sick leave will be calculated in proportion to the length of service already provided. Sick leave is not cumulative nor paid out upon termination or resignation of the employee for any reason before the expiration of his year of service. On January 1st of each year, the sick leave accrual balance will reset. The maximum carry over value is up to three (3) days of sick leave. Any days above three (3) days will be forfeited.

Sick leave will only be granted upon presentation of a medical certificate issued by the attending physician. This certificate is mandatory for any sick leave exceeding two (2) days. All sick leave requests must be tracked and recorded properly on the employee's timesheets.

10.7.3 Maternity Leave (Pre and Post Natal)

Every pregnant woman shall, on production of a medical certificate indicating the expected date, be entitled to a maternity leave during which she shall be paid as if she were continuing to work. The duration of the maternity leave is set at 12 weeks. The paid maternity leave is intended to cover six (6) weeks pre-natal and six (6) weeks post-natal. Any paid leave not taken during pre-natal leave period must be accumulated to the post-natal leave period, to ensure that the employee receives a total of 12 weeks during the maternity leave. Additionally, during the pregnancy period the employer cannot require the employee to perform work that requires considerable physical effort that are not acceptable during pregnancy.

Maternity leave is a paid leave of absence. If the worker is protected by insurance laws, the employer is obligated to pay 50% of the salary and the Dominican Social Security Institute will pay the employer a subsidy in cash, which is equal to the remaining 50% of the salary.

All maternity leave must be tracked and recorded properly on the employee's timesheets.

10.7.4 Bereavement Leave

Employees are entitled to statutory paid leave (licencia) for bereavement leave. Three (3) days paid leave is provided to employees for the death of a grandparent, parent, child, spouse or partner.

10.7.5 Marriage Leave

Employees are entitled to statutory paid leave (licencia) for their marriage. Five (5) days paid leave is provided to employees for the employee's marriage.

10.7.6 Paternity Leave

Male employees are entitled to statutory paid leave (licencia) for the birth of a child. Two (2) days paid leave is provided to male employees for the birth of a child.

10.8 Benefits Accruals

Some types of benefits may be paid out directly when they are earned, such as health benefits and therefore these types of benefits should be recorded as an expense directly in the period in which they are earned and paid.

Other benefits, such as annual leave, bonuses, severance pay, etc. are earned over time and will only be paid out later as defined by the policy above. In order to reflect the future commitment to pay as well as the proper allocation of the expense to projects, these types of benefits should be accrued monthly on the books. The amount that is earned each month should be calculated and recorded as an expense and, since no funds will actually be disbursed until the benefit is paid out in the future, an offsetting liability should be set up on the balance sheet. When the benefit is eventually paid, the payment will clear the liability account.

It is the responsibility of the FO Finance Manager to analyze Partners Dominican Republic's staff benefits package to determine if a benefit should be accrued. The FO Finance Manager must ensure that benefits accruals are well documented, as these accruals can carry over for an extended period. Accrual accounts should be reconciled monthly and proof of the reconciliation sent to Partners HQ each month. The leave accruals should match the Replicon timekeeping system totals for each employee

10.9 Social Benefits

The following social benefits will be provided to all employees of Partners Dominican Republic.

10.9.1 Maternity Rights

Female employees may not be dismissed during pregnancy or while they are nursing, unless there is a just cause for the dismissal provided by law, and a prior judicial authorization has been granted for the dismissal.

Pregnant workers cannot be required to undertake tasks involving considerable physical effort during the three (3) months before giving birth.

11. Employees

11.1 Job Descriptions

All permanent field staff positions should have job descriptions that are established, accurate and up to date. Job descriptions should reflect the actual work undertaken and should clearly outline the expectations of the worker employed in that position. A copy of the job description should be provided to each staff member when they commence work.

At times the employee supervisor should give feedback to their staff member based on a comparison of their work performance and the expectations in the job description. Partners recommends that this be in correlation with midterm or yearly performance reviews. Job descriptions should be used in the performance appraisal process to assess the employee's achievements and performance in accordance with the process established by the FO Director.

Should Partners Dominican Republic choose to alter the duties and responsibilities for a position, the job description should be subsequently altered. These changes cannot constitute an unreasonable exercise of that power, nor alter the essential conditions of the employment contract, nor cause material or moral damage to the worker. The decision to alter a job description must be made by the FO Director and employee's supervisor. If the resulting decision has budget implications, approval is also required from Partners HQ.

11.2 Performance Evaluations

The employee's supervisor will conduct a written performance evaluation on an annual basis. Initial performance evaluations will generally be performed after three months of employment upon the end of the probationary period. This evaluation will not be used as basis for salary increases. The evaluation will be written and will be based on available job descriptions, standards of performance, and such other factors which Partners Dominican Republic determines to be appropriate. Employees will have the opportunity to review, evaluate and discuss their performance as well as obtain feedback from Partners Dominican

Republic. Standards for evaluation templates will be provided by Partners HQ and found in [Annex I](#).

11.3 Salary Adjustments

Salaries for all employees are reviewed no less than 12 months after the last salary review. Adjustments to salaries are merit-based changes deriving from the performance of an individual. In all instances, increases are dependent on the overall financial health of the organization, **all merit-based salary adjustment recommendations must be approved by Partners HQ.**

11.4 Salary Advances

Salary advance are not provided under any circumstances.

11.5 Dress Code for Personnel

The image of Partners Dominican Republic is reflected in the presentation of each of its employees. Partners Dominican Republic dress code is business professional clothes from Monday to Thursday. Friday is informal and casual clothes may be worn. If employees have a field visit, it is recommended that they consider the location and to dress accordingly. All visits to the US Embassy or USAID require formal dress.

Each employee is expected to dress and groom appropriately for the job, presenting a clean and neat appearance. Attire should promote a businesslike, professional attitude and image in keeping with the employee's job and overall work environment. Any employee unsure about appropriate attire or grooming should consult with his or her supervisor. In setting standards for dress and grooming, supervisors will consider exceptions for any religious or similar considerations that are requested.

If an employee's dress or grooming does not comply with established standards, it will be discussed with the employee and the employee may be sent home for the remainder of the day (without pay) or to change clothes and return to work. If discussions fail to bring the desired result, the supervisor may initiate disciplinary action.

11.6 Communicating Absences or Delays

If an employee is delayed arriving to work or absent, he/she must notify his/her supervisor with as much advanced notice as possible. In the case of an unforeseen delay or absence, the employee will be required to call and notify his/her superior. If the delays or absences become too frequent or occur without notification, the supervisor must address a memo to the FO Director documenting such incidents. If the cumulative absences or delays in work are consecutive or unjustified Partners Dominican Republic reserves the right to take disciplinary action, up to and including termination. If an employee is absent due to illness beyond two (2) consecutive days, he/she must provide a doctor's note or medical certificate, otherwise the employee may be considered as resigning after the third consecutive day.

The FO Director of Partners Dominican Republic may terminate the employment agreement of any employee who is absent from his/her workstation two (2) consecutive days or six (6) half days in a period of one month without notice or justification is automatically considered as resigning from his/her position.

An employee who wishes to be delayed or absent for a valid personal or professional reason during working hours, must first seek and obtain the authorization of his/her immediate supervisor.

11.7 Dispute Resolution

Regrettably, conflict can occur in any work environment. To resolve the conflict in an expedient, yet fair manner, Partners Dominican Republic recommends the following process for conflict or dispute resolution.

1. Speak directly to the person you are having the dispute with. Many times, disputes arise due to misunderstandings and miscommunications.
2. If speaking to the individual does not work, please speak to your supervisor, FO Director, or any other member of Partners HQ. Then the supervisor, FO Director, or Partners HQ will arrange a meeting between those involved in the dispute, to determine a resolution.

3. If the above options are unable to resolve a workplace dispute, the parties may be referred to mediation by an outside third party. The resolution of the third-party mediator is binding on both parties of the dispute.

11.8 Disciplinary Action

Violations of this policy may result in discipline up to and including termination of employment. Note: Nothing in this policy is meant to, nor should it be interpreted to, in any way limit your rights under any applicable local laws.

Partners Dominican Republic may decide in its sole and complete discretion to warn, discipline, suspend or discharge employees with or without progressive disciplinary actions. The appropriate action will depend on the severity of the problem, the employee's past performance or the needs of the business.

Unacceptable behavior, which does not lead to immediate dismissal, may be addressed with a verbal or written warning. Written warnings will include the reasons for the supervisor's dissatisfaction and any supporting evidence. Employees will have an opportunity to defend your actions and rebut the opinion of your supervisor at the time the warning is issued. Disciplinary actions may also include suspensions or other measures deemed appropriate to the circumstances.

All pertinent facts will be carefully reviewed, and the employee will be given a full opportunity to explain his or her conduct before any decision is reached. The FO Director will give a second opinion concerning the unacceptable behavior before dismissal occurs.

11.9 Reasons for Disciplinary Action

In establishing rules of conduct, Partners Dominican Republic has no intention of restricting the personal rights of any individual. Rather, we wish to define the guidelines that protect the rights of all employees and to ensure maximum understanding and cooperation. The following list of work rules is an illustration of the type of behavior that will not be tolerated by Partners Dominican Republic. This list can be modified, reduced or extended by the employer, and must be made known to the employees. No disciplinary sanction can be

imposed on an employee if it is not included in this list, the law or has been made known to the employee. Any employee who violates any of the work rules listed below may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment. The level of disciplinary action taken will be determined at management's discretion and judged by the severity of the violation:

- Failure to comply with Partners' Dominican Republic procedures, policies or practices.
- Submission of false, misleading or incomplete information to obtain employment.
- Failure to comply with Partners' Dominican Republic Proprietary Information and Confidentiality Policy.
- Theft or inappropriate removal or possession of Partners' Dominican Republic property.
- Falsification of timekeeping records.
- Negligence or improper conduct leading to damage of employer-owned or client-owned property.
- The use, influence, purchase or sale of illicit drugs, controlled dangerous substances (excluding lawful use of prescribed medication) or alcohol on Partners Dominican Republic's property or at a work site during working hours.
- Possession of weapons, explosives or firearms on company property.
- Committing violent acts or threats of violence.
- Committing acts of illegal discrimination or harassment.
- Insubordination, including refusal to perform assigned tasks or the performance of assigned tasks in an inappropriate manner.
- Violation of safety or health rules.
- Excessive absenteeism and/or tardiness without a proper excuse.
- Failure to meet performance standards.

Failure to communicate and work well with others.

12. Risk Assessments & Contractor/Sub-recipient Monitoring

12.1 Risk Assessment Guidelines & Process

Partners Dominican Republic risk assessment validates that potential contractors/sub-recipients are viable, legitimate businesses and confirms that they have the financial capability and organizational resources to provide the required services. At the same time, it makes sure that contractor/sub-recipients are not engaged in questionable ethical or legal activities.

Each time a new contract/agreement valued at USD \$5,000 or more is signed, Partners Dominican Republic will be required to send Partners HQ a completed Risk Assessment. The Risk Assessment template is found in [Annex J](#).

12.2 Frequency of Risk Assessment

For ongoing contractor/sub-recipient monitoring activities, a follow up Risk Assessment should be completed annually in January. The completed and updated annual Risk Assessments for all contract/agreements over USD \$5,000 must be sent to Partners HQ by January 31st.

13. Procurement

13.1 Procurement Process

In Dominican Republic, a full procurement is required for all goods and services valued at USD \$2,500 or more. It is required that an appropriate competitive process be utilized and fully documented (e.g., market research for commodities/off-the shelf items; three quotes for lower expected values; full and open competition/tender for higher expected values, etc.) At minimum, a proper procurement process requires:

- Specifications, scope of work or technical requirements for the goods or services to be purchased.

- A defined criterion for selecting a good or service provider (e.g., price, capacity to deliver on time, quality of output, past performance where applicable, etc.).
- Approval from the donor to make the purchase when required.
- Solicitations of three (3) quotes or request for proposals from a pool of qualified providers or candidates.
 - In the absence of three submitted quotes or proposals, then a clearly documented memo for justification demonstrating that efforts were taken to obtain three quotes or proposals must be prepared and submitted as part of the procurement documentation.
- A memo that clearly documents the approved bid/proposal and analysis that documents the “procurement story” behind how the preferred supplier was selected and how the evaluation criteria were utilized.

In rare circumstances a sole source transaction may be permitted. A sole source transaction is one that normally would require full procurement; however, given certain circumstance, the purchase will be approved without full and open competition. This approval can only be forthcoming in writing from the FO Director or Partners HQ. Partners Dominican Republic should only consider sole source procurements in cases where there is clear evidence that the work is “so specialized” in nature that there is only one entity that could complete it. When an Employee, Representative or Affiliate proposes sole source procurement, he/she must provide clear written justification documenting the process and efforts used for determining that there are no other qualified providers.

14. Travel Policies and Procedures

14.1 Policy Overview and Applicability

The objective of this policy is to manage a travel process fully compliant with the 2 CFR 200 and Partners Dominican Republic’s rules and regulations with guidance from U.S. Government procedures.

The financial goal of this policy is to increase accountability and efficiency of travel expenditures and to ensure compliance throughout the full process of USG regulations, 2 CFR 200, and other applicable laws, including timely clearance of all travel reports (expense reports, and per diem payments).

This policy applies to all Partners Dominican Republic travelers unless otherwise indicated below. Specific guidance at a country and project level may be prepared on a case-by-case basis and approved by the CFO or CEO. In no event, shall these country or project-specific policies be out of compliance with the procedures and cost/time values identified herein.

14.2 Requesting Travel Authorization

Staff and consultants considering a trip must discuss with their supervisor the need for the trip, activities to be conducted, funding for related costs, expectations, etc. For all travelers including staff, consultants, volunteers and others traveling under Partners Dominican Republic funding, a travel authorization (TA) must be prepared prior to travel and booking of flights, hotels, etc.

All field staff and local consultants are required to complete a travel authorization, using the standard template for Field Office staff travel, and receive approval from their respective supervisors. Prior to travel all staff will complete the [Travel Itinerary & Per Diem Request Form](#). This form will collect the following information:

- Traveler's Full Name on official government ID (e.g., Passport)
- Date Requested
- Purpose of the Trip/ Scope of Work to be Performed
- Dates of Travel
- Proposed Itinerary
- Per diem requested

Once the form is completed, it will be uploaded into the Replicon platform at: <https://login.replicon.com/>. Employees will create a new expense report in Replicon to request approval for the travel authorization and per diem payment. The form will be

uploaded into the Replicon database as supporting documentation for the per diem request. The employee will electronically submit the request for approval. The respective supervisor will then review the proposed travel itinerary and per diem request, and either approve or reject for modification electronically. Once a fully approved travel itinerary and per diem request are in Replicon, employee can proceed with remaining travel plans and bookings.

14.2.1 Itinerary Changes

The appropriate supervisor should approve the traveler's itinerary changes. After receiving approval from the supervisor, travelers can contact the appropriate agency to make the necessary changes. Most importantly, it is critical that the supervisor notifies the FO Finance Department, to ensure that the per diem amount or other changes can be made as necessary. In emergency circumstances, when a supervisor is not available or after hour changes must be made immediately, it is left to the discretion of the travelers. However, they are required to notify their supervisor once the change(s) have been made. Note that the supervisor reserves the right to not approve the change. In such instance, the traveler will be responsible for any difference in cost associated with the change. Disagreements will be resolved by the CFO at Partners HQ.

14.3 Traveler Definitions

Partners' travel policy is broken out based on three traveler types. All travelers are expected to comply with and follow the provisions in their respective categories as follows:

- US based/HQ
 - US based/HQ are all individuals with their principle desk location at HQ.
 - This includes but is not limited to:
 - HQ Staff
 - Consultants
 - Interns
 - Telecommuting employees, etc.
- Local Field Office staff

- Local field staff are those on payroll at Partners field offices, including the Country Director
- Local consultant based abroad are consultants paid directly by the field office
- All other local travelers
- US based/Other
 - Including but not limited to volunteers, board members, etc.

14.4 Travel Advances

Partners Dominican Republic's policy is to only to make payments after goods and services have been supplied and conditions for payment met, therefore NO advances will be made for staff going on work related travel.

14.5 Allowable and Unallowable Expenses (Applicable to All)

The following allowable and unallowable expenses apply to all Partners Dominican Republic travelers regardless of their relationship or the location of their base.

Partners Dominican Republic has a travel policy that provides a per diem for all Meals & Incidental Expenses (M&IE), while all other miscellaneous travel expenses, lodging, rental cars, personal vehicles, airfare and train costs are reimbursed based upon actual expenses incurred. Allowable expenses are also limited to the conditions established on grants and agreements with funding agencies sponsoring the trip.

Furthermore, only allowable expenses are reimbursable under the category other miscellaneous travel expenses, lodging, rental cars, personal vehicles, airfare and trains. No later than 30 days following the final day of a trip, an Expense Reimbursement Report should be prepared and submitted to the traveler's FO Finance Department. Partners Dominican Republic will not accept reimbursement requests made after 60 days unless approved by Senior Management at HQ. All travelers requesting an exception must make their requests in writing with a valid reason for the delay.

14.5.1 Lodging – Reimbursable Based

Lodging is defined as room charges and taxes. For reimbursement purposes, a receipt must be provided. These charges cannot include room service fees, upgrade fees, mini bar tabs,

entertainment fees, etc. All of these other expenditures must be paid by the traveler using their personal or per diem funds and excluded from their lodging bill.

Partners Dominican Republic will recognize and reimburse lodging costs based on actual expenses, but the USG ceiling rates shall be a guide to appropriate expenditures per country and must not be exceeded. Exceptions above the maximum rate can be approved by the CFO or CEO. A list of USG guidance is provided below:

- [General Services Administration](#) (GSA) establishes per diem rates for destinations within the lower 48 Continental United States (CONUS).
- The [Department of Defense](#) (DOD) establishes non-foreign rates which includes Alaska, Hawaii, and all U.S. Territories (Non-CONUS).
- The [State Department](#) establishes all foreign rates which are specific to major cities.

14.5.2 Rental Cars – Reimbursable Based

The cost of rental cars including rental car insurance is allowed only if the nature of the trip or the location of business to be visited is such, that use of field transport or local transportation is unavailable, impractical or unsafe, as determined by the traveler's supervisor. If deemed necessary and approved as part of the TA process, Partners Dominican Republic will recognize and reimburse rental car costs based on actual expenses. Prior to reimbursement, the FO Finance Department will need to check that the TA includes an explanation (specific uses) as to why a car rental was necessary.

Note, Partners Dominican Republic does not carry a blanket collision damage waiver policy nor is the traveler covered with liability insurance if collision with the rental vehicle were to occur. Partners Dominican Republic recommends the purchase of collision and liability insurance each time a car is rented.

14.5.3 Use of Personal Vehicle – Reimbursable Based

The use of a personal vehicle while on travel within the Dominican Republic is permitted in lieu of airline transportation if approved by the supervisor. The traveler will be reimbursed for gas mileage in accordance with the IRS standard mileage rate. The current mileage

reimbursement is USD \$0.575 cent per mile driven for business purposes <https://www.irs.gov/newsroom/irs-issues-standard-mileage-rates-for-2020>.

14.5.4 Tolls, Parking, Etc. – Reimbursable Based

For business travel, if renting a car, using a personal vehicle or using a Partners Dominican Republic's program vehicle, Partners Dominican Republic will reimburse based on actual costs for all tolls, parking and other costs associated to the use of the vehicle. These types of expenditures are reimbursed based on actual charges incurred and a receipt must be provided for expenses over USD \$25.

14.5.5 Airfare and Trains – Reimbursable Based

Partners Dominican Republic will reimburse or purchase on behalf of all approved travelers all necessary airfare and train tickets. For reimbursement purposes, a receipt and boarding pass must be provided for all airfare and train tickets. Please note below the additional restrictions related to airfare purchases.

14.5.5.1 Seat Upgrades

Only coach class or promotional fares will be paid by Partners Dominican Republic. Business and first class are considered seat upgrades and must follow the below protocol; otherwise, this will not be covered by Partners Dominican Republic. While seat upgrades are not to be expected, there are some circumstances when the traveler could be authorized to travel Business class:

- When no space is available in coach-class accommodation and the flight must be taken;
- When use of business class is necessary to accommodate traveler disability or a special need; or
- When the cost is the same or the traveler pays for the difference in cost between coach and the upgrade.

With the exception of no-cost upgrades, or the traveler pays for the difference in cost without Partners Dominican Republic's funding, all seat upgrades will need to be approved in

advance with the FO Director and must include a written justification as to why the upgrade is necessary.

14.5.5.2 Fly America Act

All US government-funded travel will comply with [the Fly America Act](#), which requires that all travel and shipments must be made on U.S. flag carriers to the extent services by such carriers is available. Use of a Fly America compliant carrier is required regardless of whether a foreign carrier can provide the service at a comparable or lower cost, or whether a foreign carrier is preferred due to convenience. The rules generally provide for a limited number of exceptions; however, a U.S. carrier must be used for any travel: 1) within the U.S., or 2) between the U.S. and the last destination point that is served by a U.S. carrier for that particular routing. Exceptions to the Fly America Act can only be approved by Partners CFO at HQ. The exceptions are as listed below:

1. If a U.S. flag air carrier offers nonstop or direct service (no aircraft change) from your origin to your destination, you must use the U.S. flag air carrier service unless such use would extend your travel time, including delay at origin, by 24 hours or more.
2. If a U.S. flag air carrier does not offer nonstop or direct service (no aircraft change) between your origin and your destination, you must use a U.S. flag air carrier on every portion of the route where it provides service unless, when compared to using a foreign air carrier, such use would:
 - Increase the number of aircraft changes you must make outside of the U.S. by 2 or more; or
 - Extend your travel time by at least 6 hours or more; or
 - Require a connecting time of 4 hours or more at an overseas interchange point.

For a flight to be in compliance with the Fly America Act, the code of a U.S. flag air carrier must be noted as part of the flight number on the airline ticket, flight coupon (boarding pass), or passenger receipt. Each airline has a two-letter alpha code. From this list, you will be able to compare airline codes on the ticket with those on the list and thereby be able to ascertain whether or not the flight is on a US Flag air carrier. In order to ensure that the flight is Fly

America Act compliant all travel should be booked through the designated travel agent/agency.

Many of the U.S. flag air carriers are listed below:

- AirTran Airways (FL)
- Alaska Airlines (AS)
- American Airlines (AA)
- Continental Airlines (CO)
- Delta Airlines (DL)
- Frontier Airlines (F9)
- Hawaiian Airlines (HA)
- JetBlue Airways (B6)
- Midwest Express (YX)
- Southwest Airlines (WN)
- Spirit Airlines (NK)
- United Airlines (UA)
- US Airways (US)

14.5.6 Meals & Incidentals (M&IE) – Per Diem Based

Per diem means the amount of money that Partners Dominican Republic gives to the employee for an official trip out of his / her office to cover food and other expenses in accordance with current rates. Partners Dominican Republic includes the cost of all meals and incidentals under a flat rate per diem provided to the traveler and will NOT reimburse based on actual expenditures. Partial per diem will be provided when one or more of the meals is provided by someone other than the traveler.

For the appropriate amount of the per diem, please reference [Section 14.6 Per Diem for M&IE](#) to determine correct per diem based on the traveler type.

14.5.7 All Other Miscellaneous Travel Expenses (MTE) – Reimbursable Based

All other miscellaneous travel expenses (MTE) are additional expenses and paid as necessary and charged to the POA credit card or reimbursed based on the actual costs incurred. All MTE expenses over USD \$25 must be supported by receipts/stubs/invoices as part of the expense report in order to be reimbursed. MTE includes but is not limited to the following:

- All ground transportation fees (buses, taxis, etc.) between place of lodging or business and places off site to obtain meals, meetings, site visits, etc.
- Visas

- Room cleaning cost: Where an apartment is taken in lieu of hotel accommodations, the traveler may contract, however this must come from the incidental travel expense part of the per diem
- Immunizations and medications on travel
- Reproduction of materials
- Telephone calls and other communication costs that are reasonable and necessary for work-related communications
- Bank fees on exchanges currencies
- Purchase of clothing (in the event that baggage is lost, and clothing must be purchased in order to keep with meeting schedules)

14.5.8 Unallowable Expenses and Reimbursement Limitations

Partners Dominican Republic will not reimburse or cover charges for the below prohibited items. Please note these lists are not inclusive and Partners Dominican Republic reserves the right to refuse payment of any authorized or expense deemed unallowable.

14.5.8.1 Alcohol Purchases

Alcohol purchases may not be made with Partners Dominican Republic's funds while on Partners Dominican Republic travel.

14.5.8.2 Other Unallowable Expenses

Partners Dominican Republic's unallowable expenses include but are not limited to:

- Additional travel insurance, travel accident insurance or trip cancellation premiums
- Non-essential upgrades or packages
- Additional expenses associated with the cost of first or business class airfare, unless it falls into the exception categories listed above
- Childcare and babysitting expenses
- Costs incurred by your failure to cancel transportation or hotel reservations
- Costs incurred by your spouse or other dependents traveling with you, unless spouse or dependents is also on a Partners assignment
- Gasoline expenses when the automobile mileage reimbursement rate is claimed

- Hair styling and haircut expenses
- Spa, nails or other treatments
- Entertainment or tour expenses, unless activity is required by Partners Dominican Republic trip
- Kennel/boarding expenses for pets
- Costs incurred for speeding tickets, etc. when renting or driving any vehicle for Partners Dominican Republic use
- Other expenses not directly related to the business purpose of the travel assignment

For a complete list of unallowable expenses for USG funds, please reference [2 CFR Part 200](#): Unallowable Costs ([Annex K](#)) or [OMB Circular A-133](#), which includes any potential exceptions to the above unallowable expenses.

14.6 Per Diem for M&IE

Partners Dominican Republic has a travel policy that provides a per diem for all expenses related to meals and incidental expenses (M&IE). For the appropriate amount of per diem, please determine the traveler type. All travelers will fall into one of the three categories, as defined in [Section 14.3 Traveler Definitions](#).

14.6.1 M&IE Rates

All Partners Dominican Republic's M&IE per diem rates are based on a percentage of the government per diems allowed per city and/or country, as defined herein and below. Depending on the destination, travelers should utilize the General Service Administration rates for travel within the continental US, the Department of Defense rates for travel to Alaska, Hawaii, and other US territories, and the State Department for all foreign travel. The websites to obtain the rates are listed below:

- [General Services Administration](#) (GSA) establishes per diem rates for destinations within the lower 48 Continental United States (CONUS).
- The [Department of Defense](#) (DOD) establishes non-foreign rates which includes Alaska, Hawaii, and all U.S. Territories (Non-CONUS).

- The [State Department](#) establishes all foreign rates which are specific to major cities.

Per diems are driven based on the approved TA and include any travel outside of HQ or the respective Country Field Office with travel duration of four (4) hours or longer, regardless of the destination or transportation mode. Exceptions to this must be approved by the CEO or CFO.

14.6.2 M&IE Meal Breakdown

M&IE is intended to cover the costs of meals and incidentals during each day of work-related travel. For first and last days of travel (travel days), if the itinerary requires the traveler to start their travel day from their home-of-record (or work-related destination) before breakfast and return to their work-related destination (or home-of-record) after dinner, then the full per diem can be recorded and documented in the expense report. Specifically, if departure from home on first day of travel is before 6AM or arrival to home on last day of travel is after 7PM, then full per diem may be applied for a travel day. Otherwise, travel day rates will be determined as defined in [Section 14.6.4 Per Diem M&IE – Local Field Office Staff](#). The travel day rate utilized should be as follows: On first day of travel, utilize the destination city; on the last day of travel, utilize the departure city. For example, if the traveler leaves home-of-record and travels to San Diego on day one, and returns back home from San Diego on day three, during both travel days, the per diem should be calculated based on the San Diego rate.

If the daily M&IE rate excludes one or more of the meals, these are to be reduced at the following rates:

- Breakfast: 16% of daily calculated M&IE rate
- Lunch: 24% of daily calculated M&IE rate
- Dinner: 40% of daily calculated M&IE rate

Note that incidentals are calculated at 20% of the total daily rate and excluded from these meal rates; i.e., the sum of incidentals and the three meals is equal to 100% of the daily M&IE.

See examples in [Annex L](#).

14.6.3 M&IE Allowable Costs

The M&IE portion is intended to substantially cover the costs as described below.

1. The meals allowance portion is intended to include the cost of breakfast, lunch, and dinner while on travel, and is incorporated as part of the per diem.
2. Incidental travel expense portion is intended to include but are not limited to:
 - a. Fees and tips to waiters, porters, baggage handlers, bellhops, hotel servants, dining room stewards, and similar employees
 - b. Laundry, dry cleaning, and pressing of clothing
 - c. Room cleaning tips
 - d. All other incidental travel expenses as defined by Chapter 300, Part 300-3, in the Federal Travel Regulation (www.gsa.gov/fttr), under Per Diem Allowance.

US Based/HQ and local field office staff are not permitted to charge a corporate card for meals covered by their per diem, for themselves or any other individual receiving a Partners Dominican Republic's per diem. As all Partners Dominican Republic travelers receive some form of per diem, their costs should be paid for separately with per diem or personal funds. However, if the meal for the group is charged on a corporate card, this meal must be deducted from the daily per diem rate, at the rate defined above (in [Section 14.6.2 M&IE Meal Breakdown](#)) for the specified meal.

If US Based/HQ or local field office staff need to cover the cost for meal invitees (e.g. donors, etc.), they may use a corporate card to pay for the bill; however, they should deduct their meal and the meals of any other Partners Dominican Republic's per diem recipients from the bill and pay the remaining balance on the corporate card, if possible. Alternatively, they may choose to deduct the meal from the daily per diem rate received, as per the rate defined above for the specified meal. Similarly, when paying with personal credit card or cash (intending to be reimbursed), the US Based/HQ or local field office staff will only receive reimbursement for the portion of the bill that does not include meals for Partners Dominican

Republic's per diem recipients. If for some reason the bill cannot be split, and there is no other option than to pay on a corporate card, the US Based/HQ or local field office staff member must split out the portion of the bill when coding their credit card statement between personal charges and actual business expenses. The US Based/HQ or local field office staff member will be liable to pay Partners Dominican Republic back for their part of the meal and for the meals of any other Partners Dominican Republic per diem recipient charged to their Partners Dominican Republic's corporate credit card if they received an advance for per diem; otherwise, this should be deducted from the expense report when requesting travel per diem after the trip.

14.6.3.1 M&IE Weekend Travel

Should a traveler remain away from home on business over a weekend, the per diem will be allowed, assuming that the traveler is required to be away from home over the weekend for business purposes.

14.6.4 Per Diem M&IE – Local Field Office Staff

This portion of the per diem policy guidelines applies to all local field office staff, local consultants and all other local travelers based outside of the US. This policy includes the Country Director. For all full days on travel, **Local Field Office staff will receive 35% for all domestic travel and 50% for all international travel**, of the government per diem rate for the particular city (or region for travel where not all specific cities are listed).

On the first and last day of travel, in alignment with the USG guidelines, the maximum M&IE per diem will be based on **26.25% for domestic travel and 37.5% for international travel** of the government per diem rate for the particular city (or region for travel where not all specific cities are listed). See exceptions to this in [Section 14.6.2 M&IE Meal Breakdown](#) above.

If local field office staff are taking personal vacation time either before or after the Partners Dominican Republic business travel, they will not receive Partners Dominican Republic per diem those days. The local field office staff will receive the first and last travel day in accordance with the guidelines listed above, as these local field office staff local field office

staff would have had to travel to or from the office or place of residency whether or not they were on personal travel after or prior to the trip.

14.6.5 Payment of Per Diems

Regardless of the traveler, per diems will only be paid upon the Finance Office's receipt of an approved TA. The approved TA and itinerary will be the supporting documentation and authorization for the issuance of the per diem. No receipts will be required for per diem payment, except as defined in this policy.

All per diem payments should be made within 30 days from the end date of travel. Partners Dominican Republic will not accept per diem payment requests made after 60 days unless approved by Partners HQ. All travelers requesting an exception must make their requests for exceptions in writing (e.g. memorandum addressed to the FO Finance Office) with a valid reason for the delay.

It is the traveler's responsibility to utilize their per diem to cover all their meals and incidentals. Unless approved by the CEO, no additional M&IE will be provided. The traveler does not need to reimburse the organization if they do not spend all their daily M&IE.

14.6.5.1 Per Diem Payment for Local Field Office Staff

Local field office staff including the Country Director and all other local travelers outside of the US will be issued their per diem upon submission of the approved travel authorization via the Replicon platform. The per diem request with the attached travel authorization as the supporting documentation will need to be submitted by each employee in Replicon, and then approved by the appropriate supervisor in Replicon. Once completed, this information will be submitted to the FO Finance Department for direct payment into the employee's bank account within 30 days.

14.7 Reimbursement Requests (Non-Per Diem Items)

Allowable expenses that may be submitted for reimbursement as described above (lodging, rental cars, personal vehicles, airfare and trains) are all reasonable costs which are essential and directly related to the objectives of the grant and/or the main purpose of the trip.

14.7.1 Expense Reports for Reimbursement – Local Field Office Staff

No later than 30 days following the final day of a trip as necessary (in which purchases are not made on behalf of the traveler in advance), a reimbursement request should be prepared and submitted to the FO Finance Department. The method for requesting reimbursement for local field office staff will be done via the Replicon application. This report submitted in Replicon should include the following:

- A fully executed Travel Authorization/Travel Itinerary
- Replicon Expense Report which includes all proper documentation and copies of receipts attached for all items over USD \$25.
 - Please note that a bank or credit card statement is not sufficient documentation for a receipt. Where sufficient documentation has not been obtained, an affidavit will need to be filled out confirming the expenses were for business purposes and that the expenses did not include any alcohol. A copy of an appropriate affidavit is found in [Annex M](#).
- Provide evidence of the exchange rate during the period of travel (a hotel or bank receipt showing a conversion of currency may be a convenient way of satisfying this requirement.)
 - The following sites are also recommended to utilize for obtaining the exchange rate:
 - Oanda: <https://www1.oanda.com/currency/converter/>
 - XE: <https://www.xe.com/>

14.8 Personal Travel During Business Trips

If, for personal reasons, the traveler wishes to go to places other than those on the authorized Partners Dominican Republic itinerary, he/she may book and must pay for those reservations and additional costs. The traveler should also notify the FO Finance Department in writing that they are booking personal travel/personal portion of the trip. If the personal travel is booked on the same ticket as the Partners Dominican Republic authorized trip, the traveler will be responsible for covering their personal travel within 30 days of the booking. If the flight cost is a cheaper ticket price including personal days on the beginning or end of

the trip, the traveler does not need to reimburse any money. Travelers are only responsible for paying the difference of the ticket price. For example, travel dates for business ticket cost equals \$500, travel dates including a personal portion of the trip equals \$600, the staff must reimburse Partners Dominican Republic the \$100 difference between business ticket cost and personal portion of the trip. Appropriate documentation showing the additional costs must be kept on file for audit purposes.

14.9 Use of Partners Dominican Republic's Vehicles

It should be noted that only authorized employees of Partners Dominican Republic and Partners HQ are eligible to drive company vehicles. "Vehicles" are defined as cars, trucks, motorcycles or any other motorized vehicle owned by Partners Dominican Republic. Partners Dominican Republic provides vehicles for business use to allow employees to drive on designated business assignments. All employees using company vehicles must following the below requirements:

- Any driver of Partners Dominican Republic vehicles must ensure that the equipment does not experience any deterioration either by his/her direct negligence or by the fault of a third party. Therefore, the employee will personally ensure the proper physical maintenance of the vehicle he/she is responsible for by checking the daily cleanliness and routine parameters, which the employee will note before each use.
- Only authorized employees of Partners Dominican Republic are eligible to drive company vehicles.
- All authorized drivers must be 25 years or older.
- The keys should be held by authorized employees of Partners Dominican Republic who are eligible to drive company vehicles. When the vehicle is not in use or on business assignment, the keys should be returned to the FO Director.
- All individuals driving Partners Dominican Republic's vehicles, must always have a valid driver license on them while utilizing the company vehicle.
- Company vehicles are **only** to be used for business travel.

- On occasion supervisors must check the employee's driving record to ensure that the employee's record is clean and without motorized vehicle violations.
- Employees approved to drive on company business are required to inform their supervisor of any changes that may affect either their legal or physical ability to drive.
- Employees holding jobs requiring regular driving for business as an essential job function must, as a condition of employment, be able to meet the driver approval standards of this policy at all times.
- Employees should maintain the security of the vehicle and its contents, including not leaving personal items (including those of any passengers) in the vehicle at any time while unattended.
- Drivers must always drive safely and responsibly and follow all traffic regulations, including the speed limit and pay special attention to pedestrians and cyclists.
- Drivers must be mindful of the weather, and avoid driving during severe weather conditions, when feasible.
- Use of handheld cell phones (including texting) while behind the wheel of a moving vehicle being used on company business is strictly prohibited.
- Employees are responsible for any driving infractions or fines as a result of their driving.
- Nonemployees and nonbusiness passengers (i.e., family and friends) are prohibited from riding in company vehicles.
- Current registration and proof of insurance must be present in vehicle.
- Vehicle doors must be locked when in motion.
- Company vehicles shall always be secured when not in transit by being locked, keys removed, and alarms activated if so equipped.
- Employees must report any accident, theft or malicious damage involving a company vehicle to the FO Director and Partners HQ, regardless of the extent of damage or lack of injuries. Such reports must be made as soon as possible but no later than 6 hours after the incident unless employee is medically incapable of reporting.

- Employees are expected to cooperate fully with authorities in the event of an accident. However, employees should make no voluntary statement other than in reply to questions of investigating officers.
- Smoking is prohibited in all company vehicles.
- Seatbelts must always be worn by all passengers in the vehicle.
- Employees are not permitted, under any circumstances, to operate a company vehicle with any physical or mental impairment that causes the employee to be unable to drive safely. Furthermore, employees shall not operate any company vehicle while using or consuming alcohol, illegal drugs or prescription medications that may affect their ability to drive.
- The company driver is responsible for ensuring all necessary precautions are always taken to prevent damage and theft of the company vehicle and/or its contents. Whenever an employee leaves a company vehicle, the following must be done:
 - Roll up all windows
 - Lock all doors
 - Do not leave merchandise and equipment in open view inside a car, which may tempt a break-in. Remove all valuable items or lock them inside the trunk and out of sight when the vehicle is left unattended.
- Employees must take precautions to safeguard the vehicle and its contents. To the extent possible, employees must select off street parking, secure parking garages, or a lighted area close to a business or hotel entrance where normal police surveillance or security protection exists. If an employee is keeping a vehicle overnight in Santo Domingo and a secure location is not possible, then the employee must return the vehicle to Partners Dominican Republic's office location.

Any violation of the above requirements will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

14.9.1 Vehicle Driving Restrictions

Any employee who has a “major violation” in the last five years will not be eligible to drive company vehicles, unless special authorization is given by Partners HQ. Major violations include but are not limited to:

- Driving under the influence of drugs/alcohol;
- Failure to report an accident;
- Reckless driving;
- Making a false accident report;
- Driving while license is suspended or revoked; or
- Attempting to evade a police officer.

14.9.2 Vehicle Travel Restrictions

Vehicles within cities must consider the current security situations in the country. It is recommended to check with the FO Director for the restrictions in place and adhered to U.S. Embassy restrictions for travel including restrictions on departure times.

14.9.3 Vehicle Logs

Before each use, employees must complete a basic vehicle check before and update the log. Drivers must confirm that the following parts and components are in good working order: brakes, steering mechanism, horn, windshield wipers/washers, rear-vision mirrors, lights, and tires. Vehicles found to be in an unsafe condition may not be operated for until properly repaired.

After the basic check is completed, employees will need to report any damages and/or issues with the vehicle on the approved tracking sheet. A mileage log must be maintained for each vehicle, identifying the date and purpose of each trip and the beginning and ending odometer readings. Upon finalizing the use of the vehicle at the end of each day, the employee will need to update the log and report any damages and/or issues with the vehicle. If an employee fails to update the mileage log and perform the vehicle check, they may face disciplinary action.

14.9.4 Reporting Vehicle Accidents

In case of an accident, the employee should take the following steps:

- If anyone is hurt, call for medical assistance;
- Contact the FO Director and Partners HQ immediately;
- Report the incident immediately to the local police and obtain a copy of the police report;
- Get the below information if possible:
 - Nature and extent of the damage to vehicles and other property;
 - Name and address of the legal owner of the other vehicle or vehicles, if any.
 - Name, address, driver's license number, and date of birth of the driver of the other vehicle or vehicles, if any;
 - License number, make and model of the other vehicle or vehicles, if any;
 - Name of the insurance company of any other driver or drivers, policy number and expiration date, and policy holder's name and address;
 - Time, place and date of the accident;
 - Names and addresses of anyone injured and description of injuries; and
 - Names and addresses of any passengers and other witnesses.
- Exchange vehicle identification, insurance company name and policy numbers with the other driver (if applicable);
- Do not admit negligence or liability. Give no information except as required by law enforcement officers;
- Do not attempt settlement, regardless of how minor;
- Take a photograph of the scene of accident;
- Complete the employee accident report found in [Annex G](#).

After the accident, the employee should follow legal guidelines for exchanging information with other drivers and report the accident to local police. Employees cannot guarantee payment to other parties without Partners Dominican Republic's authorization.

The employee will be responsible for completing the Employee Accident Report Form found in [Annex G](#). Such reports must be made as soon as possible but no later than 6 hours after

the incident unless employee is medically incapable of reporting. All photos, police reports, employee accident reports, and other information relating to the incident must be retained and a copy sent to Partners HQ. The FO Director will work with Partners HQ to contact the insurance provider and file claim, as necessary.

14.9.5 Vehicle Repairs

For all vehicle repairs, employees must review the warranty on the vehicle when applicable. The warranty must be reviewed to ensure that the repairs are not covered under the existing warranty and/or that the repairs are done at the necessary shop which are authorized outlets for service. Additionally, the driver must check that the original parts of the vehicle are not replaced used parts, a dishonest practice quite common for radiators, batteries, lamps etc. in some places.

14.9.5.1 Normal Vehicle Maintenance

The driver will respect the normal maintenance schedule of the vehicle, usually based on the mileage of the car or the number of months of use if it occurs before. The objective is to maintain company vehicles in a safe and operating condition by using the most economical, reliable, and up-to-date procedures and technologies available, all in accordance with the original manufacturer's recommendations. Employees who are having vehicles serviced for normal maintenance, should follow all necessary procurement standards and recommended maintenance timelines.

14.9.5.2 Major Vehicle Repairs

Major vehicle repairs are those valued at USD \$500 and above. For all major repairs, the employee will be required to obtain three (3) quotes from a pool of qualified service providers. The FO Director in coordinator with Partners HQ will review the quotes and select the best provider. The overall process and selection of the provider will be documented in accordance with the normal procurement standards in [Section 13](#). If the major repair pertains to an accident report and an insurance claim is filed, then Partners HQ in coordination with the FO Director will work with the insurance agent to cover the cost less any deductible.

14.9.6 Vehicle Insurance and Registration

Under Partners HQ's vehicle insurance policy, it provides protection to authorized drivers of company vehicles while on official business. The insurance policy covers collision, fire, theft and liability and includes a deductible. If the accident is due to driver negligence, the insurance claim may be denied, and Partners Dominican Republic will be responsible for all costs associated with the incident.

All Partners Dominican Republic's vehicle must be registered in Dominican Republic with the appropriate authorities. Any vehicle that is not properly registered cannot be used for business, until the registration is updated. Copies of current vehicle registration information must always be retained in the glovebox of the vehicle, and a second copy filed with the FO Finance Manager.

Annex A

Master Equipment & Supply Listing

[illegible]

Annex B

Petty Cash Count

Partners of the Americas - USAID649 Dominican Republic Field Office - Petty Cash Count			
Petty Cash Count on		7-Jan-20	
Bank Notes	2,000 Pesos		DOP 0.00
	1,000 Pesos		DOP 0.00
	500 Pesos		DOP 0.00
	200 Pesos		DOP 0.00
	100 Pesos		DOP 0.00
	50 Pesos		DOP 0.00
	20 Pesos		DOP 0.00
Coins	Coins Total		DOP 0.00
	Total Cash On Hand		DOP 0.00
<i>By signing below I certify that I have conducted a cash count and verified Petty Cash Float in the presence of the petty cash float holder on:</i>			1/7/2020
Prepared by:	Rosa Samboys Trinidad	Signature:	
Title of Preparer:	Administrative Assistant & Accountant	Date:	1/7/2020
Certified by:	Rosa Iris Almonte Abreu	Signature:	
Title of Certifier:	Country Director	Date:	1/7/2020
Remarks:			

Field Expenditure Report and Certification

Partners of the Americas

General Information & Certifications

Certification of Expenses:	
1. The undersigned hereby certifies (1) the fiscal report & attachments have been prepared from the books & records of the field office in accordance with the terms of the grant award, and to the best of my knowledge and belief, that they are correct, that the sum claimed under this award is proper and that all the costs of the field office performance (except as herewith reported in writing has been accrued or paid or will be paid currently to the award when due in the ordinary course of business.)	
2. That the work reflected by the costs above have been performed, that the quantities and amounts involved are consistent with the requirements of the award.	
3. That all required approvals have been obtained and appropriate refund to Partners of the Americas will be made upon request in the event of disallowance of costs not reimbursable under the term of this award.	
4. By signing this report, I certify that the expenses contained in the present report for month of <u>XXXXXX</u> equivalent to US dollars <u>XXXXXXX</u> were incurred by the field office, and are related to activities carried out by the project. I certify to the best of my knowledge and belief that the report is true, complete, and accurate, and that the expenditures and disbursements are for the purposes and objectives set forth in the terms and conditions of the USAID Award. I am aware that any false, fictitious, or fraudulent information, or the omission of any material fact, may subject me to criminal, civil or administrative penalties for fraud, false statements, false claims or otherwise. I understand that if the expenses contained herein are questioned or not approved by Partners CFO or by USAID, I will provide full cooperation to all the involved parties to complete such review, audit or investigation.	

Signature:

PARTNERS of the AMERICAS
 Connect • Serve • Change Lives

USAID649 - Dominican Republic

Bank Reconciliation

Bank Account: XXXXX

Month and Year:
 Exchange Rate for the Month DOP to USD
According to the Bank
 Balance as end of: *August-19*
Plus:
 Deposits in Transit
Less:
 Check in Transit

Aug-19

49.00

DOP 0.00

DOP 0.00

DOP 0.00

Number of Check	Details of Expense	Date	Amount
			DOP 0.00
			DOP 0.00
			DOP 0.00
			DOP 0.00
			DOP 0.00
			DOP 0.00
			DOP 0.00

Balance According to the Bank:
 Exchange Rate Applied DOP to USD
 USD Balance According to the Books end of:

August-19
 August-19

DOP 0.00

49.00

\$ -

According to the Books
 Balance as Beginning of:
Plus:
 Deposits for the Month
Less:
 Check Written in Current Month

August-19
 August-19

DOP 0.00

DOP 0.00

DOP 0.00

DOP 0.00

DOP 0.00

DOP 0.00

DOP Balance According to the Books end of:
 Exchange Rate Applied DOP to USD
 USD Balance According to the Books end of:

August-19
 August-19

DOP 0.00

49.00

\$ -

By signing this report, I certify that the expenses contained in the present report for month of XXXXXX equivalent to US dollars XXXXXX were incurred by the entity, and are related to activities carried out by the project. I certify to the best of my knowledge and belief that the report is true, complete, and accurate, and that the expenditures and disbursements are for the purposes and objectives set forth in the terms and conditions of the USAID Award. I am aware that any false, fictitious, or fraudulent information, or the omission of any material fact, may subject me to criminal, civil or administrative penalties for fraud, false statements, false claims or otherwise. I understand that if the expenses contained herein are questioned or not approved by Partners CFO or by USAID, I will provide full cooperation to all the involved parties to complete such review, audit or investigation.

Prepared By: _____
Finance-Administrative Director

Date: _____

Approved By: _____
Project Director

Date: _____

Annex D

Cash Flow Request

 PARTNERS of the AMERICAS Connect • Serve • Change Lives					
Partners of the Americas					
CASH FLOW REQUEST for Jan-20					
Office:	Dominican Republic	Currency:	DOP	Date Requested:	1/7/2020
Program/Grant #:	USAID649				
Exchange Rate of DOP to USD					52.00
					Amount
Bank Balance as of 1/7/2020					DOP 289,898.28
Current Bank Balance in USD					\$ 5,574.97
Petty Cash Balance as of 1/7/2020					DOP 15,000.00
Current Petty Cash in USD					\$ 288.46
Last Cash Flow Request in USD					\$ 8,575.23
Are these funds in your bank account as of 1/7/2020 ?					Yes
Total Cash on Hand					\$ 5,863.43
Projection for Unpaid Obligations this Month in USD					\$ 5,291.79
Total Projections for Next Month in USD (Rounded Numbers)					Jan-20 \$ 18,295.15
<i>Local Personnel (Includes Country Director & All Field Staff)</i>					\$ 6,976.67
<i>Local Fringe (Includes SS, aguinaldo, Med. Life & Severance)</i>					\$ -
<i>Local Consultants (Short Term Contracts)</i>					\$ -
<i>Supplies (All Equipment & Supplies below \$5,000 USD in Value)</i>					\$ -
<i>Meetings and Events</i>					\$ -
<i>Staff Travel (transportation, hotels, per diems, airfare, etc. when not with FTF Volunteer)</i>					\$ -
<i>Communication</i>					\$ -
<i>Office Rent & Utilities</i>					\$ -
<i>Volunteer Travel-Related Costs (Includes cost of local staff travel when on travel with FTF Volunteer,</i>					\$ -
<i>Bank Fees & Misc. Service Charges/Interest</i>					\$ -
Total					\$ 6,976.67
Necessary Funding for Next Month					\$ 6,405.03
Total Cash Flow Request					\$ 6,405.03
By signing below I certify that I have conducted a petty cash count and verified that the amount above is accurate and available.					
Prepared by:	Rosa Samboys Trinidad			Signature:	
Title of Preparer:	Administrative Assistant & Accountant			Date:	1/7/2020
Certified by:	Rosa Iris Almonte Abreu			Signature:	
Title of Certifier:	Country Director			Date:	1/7/2020

Annex E

Petty Cash Certification

Date

Name of Country Director/Chief of Party

Country Director/Chief of Party

Dear **Name of Country Director/Chief of Party**:

Re: CERTIFICATE OF PETTY CASH FLOAT HELD

TOTAL OF PETTY CASH FLOAT: _____

LESS TOTAL PETTY CASH VOUCHERS: _____

EQUALS TOTAL CASH ON HAND: _____

I certify that I have conducted a cash count on _____ (date) and verified Petty Cash Float in the presence of the petty cash float holder.

PETTY CASH VERIFIER: _____ Name

Signature

PETTY CASH FLOAT HOLDER: _____ Name

Signature

Annex F

Harassment Complaint Form

The information you provide below is considered sensitive and will be shared only with those who are considered essential to the investigation and disposition of this complaint. Do not feel limited by the space provided in this form – you are encouraged to attach additional pages if you believe it will assist in the investigation.

If you are more comfortable with verbally relaying your report, your supervisor or any member of management you've discussed your complaint with can complete the form on your behalf. However, you must sign the last page.

<i>Complainant Name:</i>	
<i>Position:</i>	
<i>Department:</i>	
<i>Supervisor:</i>	
<i>1. Describe the alleged harassment incident(s).</i>	
<i>2. Who was responsible for the alleged harassment incident(s)?</i>	

3. Identify any witnesses to the alleged harassment incident(s).	
4. Where did the alleged harassment incident(s) take place?	
5. List the date(s) and time(s) that the alleged harassment incident(s) occurred.	
6. Have you reported this incident to anyone else? If so, whom?	
Employee Signature	Date
Signature of Person Completing Form (if not employee):	Date
Name of Person Completing Form (if not employee):	

Partners Dominican Republic is an equal opportunity employer. It is Partners Dominican Republic's policy that all employees have a right to work in an environment free of discrimination and harassment based on race, color, sex, gender, age, religion, language, disability, nationality, sexual orientation, economic situation, union or religious belief, political or philosophical opinion, social or personal condition, national ancestry or social origin or any other basis protected by local law. Partners Dominican Republic's policy prohibits retaliation against any employee for complaining about discrimination or harassment.

Annex G

Employee Incident Report

A. Injured Employee Data		
Employee Name:	Position:	Full Name of Witness (If applicable):
Work Location:		
Date of Accident	Time of Accident A.M. ☐ P.M. ☐	Claim Number (if known)
Phone:	Other/Cell Number:	Email:
Supervisor		Supervisor Telephone Number

Check all that Apply:

Type of Accident/Loss: () Injury () Vehicle Accident () Illness () Property Damage () Fire

() Other-Specify: _____

Location of Occurrence: () On Premises - Office () Off-Premises

Nature of Injury/Illness: (Strain, Laceration, Burn, Fracture, etc.) _____

Part(s) of Body: (Back, Finger, Hand, Foot, etc.) _____

Date of 1st Medical Treatment: __Time__ AM/PM

Employee Sent: () Back to Work () To Doctor () Home () To Hospital

If applicable: Estimated Time of Disability: _____ Days

For Vehicle Accidents Only

Owner: () Partners Dominican Republic () Other (Name/Address) _____

License Plate Number: _____ Year: _____

Make/Model: _____

Brief Damage Description:

Repair Hours (Estimated)_____

Estimated Material Costs \$_____

B. Accident Description

Instructions: Obtain written and/or recorded statements from injured employee. What happened? What caused the accident? What were the contributing factors? Reconstruct the sequence of events that led to the injury. Attach additional sheets if necessary. This document becomes an official accounting of the facts surrounding the accident. When documenting the facts, include answers to the following questions:

Where did the accident happen and who was involved? Provide a full description of the surroundings of the location and the individuals involved.

What was happening at the time of the accident and why was it taking place?

What were the events leading up to the accident? Describe the sequence in order and when they took place.

What exactly caused the injury and how did it happen? What were the mechanics, equipment or tools involved?

Describe the injury or injuries incurred. What body part and what kind of injury? (Indicate if no injury occurred.)

If a physical injury was avoided, what could have happened to cause an injury?
7. If damage occurred to employer vehicle, please describe the damage:
8. If damage occurred to employer equipment, please describe the damage:
C. Accident Findings
After review of all facts, what was the hazardous condition, unsafe work practice, or other causal factors (procedure, equipment, people, and environment) that contributed to the accident / injury?

Employee Signature: _____

Date: _____

Witness Signature (If Applicable): _____

Date: _____

Supervisor Signature: _____

Date: _____

Employee Accident Investigation Report

To Be Conducted by FO Director

For all question below please write one of the following: (Y for Yes; N for No; NA for Not Applicable)

I. Environmental Data

Temperature_____

Humidity_____

Weather_____

Wind_____

Visibility_____

Lighting_____

Surface (road, steps, floor, etc.).

Condition (smooth, wet, slippery, etc.)

Type Surface (wood, asphalt, grass, etc.)

Describe Roadway (Curve, uphill, intersection, etc.) _____

Traffic Control Devices (Y/N):

(1) Present_____

(2) Visible_____

For ramps, stairs, steps (Y/N):

(1) Present_____

(2) Obstructions_____

II. Operator/Vehicle (If applicable)

A. Driver Injured_____

B. Passengers Injured _____

C. Others Injured_____

D. Vehicle Damaged_____

F. Other Vehicle Damaged_____

G. Other Property Damaged_____

H. Driver Licensed for Vehicle_____

I. Seat Belts Worn_____

J. Alcohol/Drugs Involved _____

III. Equipment/Training Data

A. Safety Equipment Required_____

B. Safety Equipment Available_____

C. Safety Equipment Used_____

D. Experience a Factor_____

E. Instructions Available_____

F. Instructions Written_____

G. Instructions Adequate_____

H. Alcohol/Drugs a Factor_____

I. Adequate Rest for Use_____

Have similar accident occurred before? _____

How many accidents has this employee had in the past 12 months? _____

Of the above accidents how many were preventable? _____

Once the investigator has completed the questions above and reviewed the incident report, answer the following questions:

In your opinion, what caused the accident?

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|---|
| A. Unsafe Procedure _____ | Was this Preventable _____ or Non-Preventable _____ |
| B. Defective Equipment _____ | Was this Preventable _____ or Non-Preventable _____ |
| C. Horseplay/Misconduct _____ | Was this Preventable _____ or Non-Preventable _____ |
| D. Unauthorized Use _____ | Was this Preventable _____ or Non-Preventable _____ |
| E. Poor Hygiene/Housekeeping _____ | Was this Preventable _____ or Non-Preventable _____ |
| F. Lack of Training/Experience _____ | Was this Preventable _____ or Non-Preventable _____ |

D. Corrective Action
What is recommended to prevent this type of accident from occurring again?
List possible factors based on descriptive narrative and information in preceding data fields:
List causes:
Corrective Action Taken/Planned, with dates:

Use Additional Forms and Paper if Required

Investigated by: _____

Investigator Signature: _____

Date: _____

Reviewed by: _____

Reviewer Signature: _____

Date: _____

Annex H

Application for Employment

EEO Statement: Partners of the Americas is an equal opportunity employer and will not discriminate against any application for employment on the basis of actual or perceived race, color, religion, national origin, religion, sex (including pregnancy, childbirth, and other pregnancy-related conditions), age (18 and over), marital status (including parenthood), personal appearance, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, family responsibilities, genetic information, disability, veteran status, matriculation, political affiliation or any other basis prohibited by law.

General Information:

Date: _____

Full Name: _____

Current Email Address: _____

Current Address: _____

Day Phone Number: _____ Evening Phone Number: _____

_____	_____	_____	☐ Full-Time
Position Desired	Salary Desired	Earliest Start Date	☐ Part-Time
			☐ Intern

Have you ever applied to Partners of the Americas before? _____

If yes, when: _____

How did you find out about Partners of the Americas? _____

Are you legally permitted to work in this country? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Have you ever been convicted of a crime other than a minor traffic violation? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, give details on a separate page and attach to the application.

Note: A criminal conviction is not an absolute bar to employment but will be considered in relation to specific job requirements.

Education / Training:

High School	City & State	Degree
-------------	--------------	--------

Did you graduate: ☐ No ☐ Yes

College	City & State	Degree
---------	--------------	--------

Did you graduate: ☐ No ☐ Yes

Graduate/Trade School	City & State	Degree
-----------------------	--------------	--------

Did you graduate: ☐ No ☐ Yes

Previous Experience (Start with current or most recent employer):

Firm Name	From (Month/Year) To (Month/Year)	Salary
-----------	-----------------------------------	--------

Address (Street, City, State, Zip)

Job Title	Supervisor's Name	Phone #
-----------	-------------------	---------

Responsibilities: _____

Reason for Leaving: _____

May we contact the above employer? ☐ Yes ☐ No If no, please provide explanation.

Firm Name	From (Month/Year) To (Month/Year)	Salary
-----------	-----------------------------------	--------

Address (Street, City, State, Zip)

Job Title Supervisor's Name Phone #

Responsibilities: _____

Reason for Leaving: _____

May we contact the above employer? ☐ Yes ☐ No If no, please provide explanation.

Firm Name From (Month/Year) To (Month/Year) Salary

Address (Street, City, State, Zip)

Job Title Supervisor's Name Phone #

Responsibilities: _____

Reason for Leaving: _____

May we contact the above employer? ☐ Yes ☐ No If no, please provide explanation.

Additional Qualifications:

Please identify any additional knowledge, skills, qualifications or awards that will be helpful to us in considering your application for employment.

References:

Please provide the names of three professional references, not related to you, who can best provide pertinent information as to your character and capabilities for the position you are applying or being considered for. These individuals are generally your previous supervisors.

Name/Title:

Organization:

Relationship:

Email

Telephone #:

Applicant's Certification:

Applicant's Certification of Truthfulness, Agreement to Background Checks and Understanding of "AT WILL" Employment

I hereby certify that all statements made in this application and in the pre-employment process are true and correct to the best of my knowledge and belief. I understand and agree that any misrepresentation or omission of facts in my application or in the pre-employment process may result in rejection of my application or termination of my employment.

I understand an employee of Partners of the Americas may make an investigation as to my character and general reputation. I authorize all current and past employers, schools, persons and organizations having relevant information or knowledge to provide it to Partners of the Americas for the use in deciding whether or not to offer me employment. I hereby release Partners of the Americas its representatives and all such employers, schools, persons and organizations from all liability in making or responding to inquiries in connection with my application.

Per the Dominican Republican Constitution, I understand that partners of the Americas will not use police records and criminal records as a reason to restrict any constitutional right including the right to work the right to work. Furthermore, Partners of the Americas in accordance with the Dominican Republican Constitution prohibits any form of discrimination which affects access to work.

I understand that if an employment relationship is established my employment can be terminated at any time, with or without cause or notice, at the option of either Partners of the Americas or myself. I further understand that nothing contained in this application or in any other oral communication or representation from Partners of the Americas or any Partners of the Americas representative made at any time constitutes a contract, guarantee, promise or any other binding obligation on Partners of the Americas.

Further, if granted a position with Partners of the Americas, I will comply with all of Partners of the America's policies and procedures, a copy of which will be provided on or before my first week of employment.

In signing this form, I certify that I understand all the questions and statements in this application.

Acknowledged:

Signature of Applicant

Date

Performance Evaluation Template

EMPLOYEE PERFORMANCE EVALUATION

EMPLOYEE NAME		REVIEWER NAME	
EMPLOYEE TITLE		REVIEWER TITLE	
DATES OF REVIEW	January 1, 2019 - December 31, 2019	TODAY'S DATE	
CHARACTERISTICS			
QUALITY	RATING SCALE	COMMENTS	
Works to Full Potential (not distracted & able to complete quality work)			
Takes Initiative (doesn't wait to be asked to start doing his/her work)			
Time Management (consistently meets deadlines with quality & accuracy)			
Communication (responds promptly & accurately to requests)			
Accountability (follows policies & procedures)			
Financial Management (accurate & responsibly handling funds)			
Coworker Relations (interacting respectfully & in good behavior with staff)			
Attendance & Punctuality (is on time to work - in the field of office, and has excused absences)			
COUNTRY DIRECTOR TECHNICAL ROLE			
Designed well-written country project strategies			
Identifies local host organizations			

Onboards field staff - review Field Office Manual & POA policies		
Ensures project Scopes of Work meet the country's project strategy		
Oversees in-country travel & logistics for volunteers & staff		
Produces comprehensive & well-written content to POA for reports		
Establishes relationships with hosts, partners, & other stakeholders		
Follows POA's instructions and implements updates		
Successfully supervises field staff & keeps them accountable		
Monitors & evaluates the quality & impact of volunteer assignments		
OVERALL SCORE /80		
GOALS FOR NEXT PERIOD		
COMMENTS		
EMPLOYEE SIGNATURE		REVIEWER SIGNATURE

DEFINITION OF RATINGS

EXCEPTIONAL (5): Consistently exceeds all relevant performance standards. Provides leadership, fosters teamwork, is highly productive, innovative, responsive and generates top quality work. Active in industry-related professional and/or community groups.

EXCEEDS EXPECTATIONS (4): Consistently meets and often exceeds all relevant performance standards. Shows initiative and versatility, works collaboratively, has strong technical and interpersonal skills or has achieved significant improvement in these areas.

MEETS EXPECTATIONS (3): Meets all relevant performance standards. Seldom exceeds or falls short of desired results or objectives. Lacks appropriate level of skills or is inexperienced/still learning the scope of the job.

BELOW EXPECTATIONS (2): Sometimes meets the performance standards. Seldom exceeds and often falls short of desired results. Performance has declined significantly, or employee has not sustained adequate improvement, as required since the last performance review or performance improvement plan.

NEEDS IMPROVEMENT (1): Consistently falls short of performance standards.

Risk Assessment Templates

Sub-recipient Monitoring Tool- First Time



PARTNERS of the AMERICAS
Connect • Serve • Change Lives

FIRST TIME RISK ASSESSMENT

Sub-Grantee Check List

Name of Project & Grant Number:
Fixed Obligation Grant/Contract:
Cost Reimbursable Grant/Contract:
Staff Name Completing Form:
Date Completed:

Yes or No	Overall Score		
Yes or No	0		
	High Risk	Medium Risk	Low Risk
	361-530	202-360	0-201

Grading Legend:

Low Risk	Medium Risk	High Risk
0-3	4 - 6	7 - 10

No.	Description	Review Areas/ Action Required	Answers to Questions	Rating Risk
1	Organization and Administration			
	1.1 Entity Details and Registration Compliance			
	Is your organization registered in country?	Ex. Registration documents		
	1.2 Business Structure			
	Is your business a LLC, Corporation, Sole-Proprietorship, etc.?			
	Who is ultimately responsible for business liabilities, debts and actions?			
	1.3 Funding			
	In your company's preceding fiscal year, did your company received 50% or more of its annual gross revenues from US federal contracts?			
	Has the organization received during the previous year \$300,000 or more in US Government funds?	Check audit reports		
	1.4 Project Operations			
	Is there an organizational chart? Is it updated?			
	Is staff aware of reporting structures?			
	Is there segregation of duties?			
	Does the organization have an Operations Manual?			
	Are the key elements of an Operations Manual present?	1) Project definition and scope 2) Project objectives 3) Mgmt. standards & procedures 4) Organizational chart 5) Phone/mobile use policy 6) Financial & HR procedures 7) Staffing requirements 8) Archiving policy 9) Procurement procedures 10) Travel Policy 11) Critical success criteria		
	1.5 Safety and Security Plan			
	Is there a Safety and Security Plan on file with up-to-date emergency contact information?			
	1.6 Human Resources and Personnel			
	Are there Personnel Files? Do they have proper backup and filing systems?	Is there a CV or Bio-data, offer letter or employee contract? Is there a job description? Is signed copy of contract? Test: Random check of each personnel file to verify documentation. How are salary distributions made? Are they properly documented?		
	1.7 Finance			
	Do financial systems effectively capture their activities?			
	Are POA project activities reported separately from other activities?			
	Is there a chart of accounts?			
	Is there evidence of proper financial documentation?	Payment ,receipt, journal entry, petty chase, invoices, payroll slips, bank statements, bank reconciliations		
	Does the organization keep a separate bank account for POA/USG funds?			
	What is the company's average monthly expenditure?			
	1.8 Reporting			
	Is there adequate reporting and tracking of funds?			
	Has the organization worked with cost share requirement before?			
	1.9 Staffing/Human Resources			
	Is there a written HR Policy? (includes the signing document of conflict of interest)			
	Is there a clear delineation of roles and responsibilities?	Ex. Responsible person for financial reporting, cash management, procurement, invoices, payroll, general accounts, property management		
	Are employees benefit plans readily available (medical, insurances, allowances, bonus policies etc.)?	Evidence (health plan, workplace insurance, overtime register, training policy, etc.)		
	Are personnel contracts available in hard copy?			
	Are consultant contracts available in hard copy?			
	1.10 Travel			
	Does the organization have its own travel policy?			
	Total score for Organization and Administration			0
				Organization and Administration scoring
				High Risk Medium Risk Low Risk
				175-260 100-174 0-99
2	Risk Management			
	2.1 Anti-corruption / Sanctions Lists / Counter Terrorism			
	Has POA conducted a screening of the organization and people working for a project? Ex. SAM Check, OFAC Check, Compliance Check			
	2.2 Risk Management			
	Is there a Business Ethics Program?	Filing list, hard and soft copy files, compliance		
				Risk Management Scoring

Sub-recipient Monitoring Tool- Recurring Policy



PARTNERS of the AMERICAS
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REOCCURRING RISK ASSESSMENT Sub-Grantee Monitoring & Evaluation Check List

Name of Project:

Fixed Obligation Grant/Contract:

Cost Reimbursable Grant/Contract:

Staff Name Completing Form:

Date Completed:

Yes or No	Overall Score		
Yes or No	0		
	High Risk	Medium Risk	Low Risk
	556-840	276-555	0-275

Grading Legend:

Low Risk	Medium Risk	High Risk
0-3	4 - 6	7 - 10

No.	Description	Review Areas/ Action Required	Action Required	Rating Risk
1	Organization and Administration			
	1.1 Funding			
	In your company's preceding fiscal year, did your company received 50% or more of its annual gross revenues from US federal contracts?			
	Has the organization received during the previous year \$300,000 or more in US Government funds?	Check audit reports		
	1.2 Project Operations			
	Is there an organizational chart? Is it updated?			
	Is staff aware of reporting structures?			
	Is there segregation of duties?			
	Does the organization have an Operations Manual?			
	Are the key elements of an Operations Manual present?	1) Project definition and scope 2) Project objectives 3) Mgmt. standards & procedures 4) Organizational chart 5) Phone/mobile use policy 6) Financial & HR procedures 7) Staffing requirements 8) Archiving policy 9) Procurement procedures 10) Travel Policy 11) Critical success criteria		
	Is there a vehicle usage log, which is maintained, reviewed and pre-determined based on a schedule? Is there an office policy on vehicle usage?			
	Are fixed assets labeled, marked and entered into a log/register?			
	Are asset registers being updated regularly and checked at least annually?	Spot check assets and asset register/s		
	Are tags/unique identifier numbers assigned to each item?			
	1.3 Safety and Security Plan			
	Is there a Safety and Security Plan on file with up-to-date emergency contact information?			
	1.4 Human Resources and Personnel			
	Are there Personnel Files?	Is there a CV or Bio-data, offer letter or employee contract? Is there a job description? Is signed copy of contract? Test: Random check of each personnel file to verify documentation.		
	Do they have proper backup and filing systems?	How are salary distributions made? Are they properly documented?		
	1.5 Finance			
	Do financial systems effectively capture their activities?			
	Are POA project activities reported separately from other activities?			
	Is there a chart of accounts?			
	Is there evidence of proper financial documentation?	Payment, receipt, journal entry, petty chase, invoices, payroll slips, bank statements, bank reconciliations		
	Does the organization keep a separate bank account for POA/USG funds?			
	What is the company's average monthly expenditure?			
	1.6 Reporting			
	Is there adequate reporting and tracking of funds?			
	Is the organization reporting cost share?			
	Are the items reported as cost share reasonable and allowable?			
	Are the items reported as cost share properly documented?			
	1.7 Project Management			
	Are funding and staffing resource estimates sufficiently detailed and documented for use in planning and tracking the grant?	e.g.: Yearly budgets, Staffing plan		
	Are project deliverables clearly defined and understood by project staff?			
	Are target dates established for each milestone/deliverable?			
	Are project invoices being submitted to POA on time?	Spot check last 3 invoices		
	Is there a document retention policy?			
	1.8 Staffing/Human Resources			
	Is there a written HR Policy? (includes the signing document of conflict of interest)			
	Is there a clear delineation of roles and responsibilities?	Ex. Responsible person for financial reporting, cash management, procurement, invoices, payroll, general accounts, property management		
	Are employees benefit plans readily available (medical, insurances, allowances, bonus policies etc.)?	Evidence (health plan, workplace insurance, overtime register, training policy, etc.)		
	Is there an up-to-date list of project employees?			
	Is there an up-to-date list of project consultants?			
	Are employee salary and consultant payments in accordance with the approved budget?			
	Are personnel contracts available in hard copy?			
	Are consultant contracts available in hard copy?			
	1.9 Travel			
	Is there authorized travel by POA?	Check approved budget and other documentation		
	Does the organization have its own travel policy?			
	Are Travel Expense Reports (TERs) submitted correctly, on time, and with appropriate approvals?	Spot check		
	Is the correct M&IE rate being used?			
	Are itemized receipts attached to the TER?			
	Are only allowable expenses being reimbursed?			
	Are Travel Advances being cleared according to the organization's policy			
	1.10 Conferences			
	Is there proof that funds went to specific conferences cited in deliverables?	Check for participants list, hotel reservations, receipts, and other documentation		
	Total score for Organization and Administration			

Organization and Administration scoring		
High Risk	Medium Risk	Low Risk
291-450	141-290	0-140

2	Risk Management				
	2.1	Anti-corruption / Sanctions Lists / Counter Terrorism			
		Has POA conducted a screening of the organization and people working for a project? Ex. SAM Check, OFAC Check, Compliance Check			
	2.2	Integrity Systems Check			
		Has the Code of Conduct been signed by appropriate staff members?	Ex. Random check 10 personnel files		
		Is the Code of Conduct readily available?			
	2.3	Risk Management			
		Are local contract templates being checked regularly (at least every two years) to make sure they are in line with country workplace laws?	Evidence of local legal advice		
		Are there soft copies of Grant Agreements and Amendments on file?			
		Are there hard copies of Grant Agreements and Amendments on file?	Check hard copies		
		Is there a Project Filing System?	Filing list, hard and soft copy files, compliance with Sharepoint filing system		
				Risk Management Scoring	
				High Risk	Medium Risk
				Low Risk	
		Total score for Management		0	
3	Finance and Procurement				
	3.1	Financial Operations			
		Are there financial management procedures?	Spot check; evidence of FM procedures and use		
		Is the staff aware of the financial management procedures?			
		Do records show correct signatures in line with delegated authority ?	Spot check 10 items		
		Are the expenses reasonable, allowable and allocable?	Spot check 10 items		
		Are financial records being kept in hard copy?	Sight hard copies		
		Are financial records being kept in soft copy?	Check SharePoint or Local Server copies		
		Is the project budget being updated regularly and with reasonable accuracy?	Check latest forecast, date and signature. Should be signed off each month, even if no change.		
		Is there a budget variance greater than 10% per category?			
		Are grant funds routinely requested to meet obligations?			
	3.2	Payroll			
		Is payroll calculated each month?	By whom and how?		
		Are all applicable taxes being withheld?	Ex. Income tax, PAYE		
		Are individual payroll sheets for each staff member available?			
		Do payroll sheets detail other benefits and percentage allocation?			
	3.3	Audit			
		Are annual audits being undertaken either internally or externally?	Annual audit reports		
		Are project audits stipulated per the grant?	Check contract/grant		
		If yes, are they being conducted and findings submitted to POA?			
		Has your company currently or previously been involved in any litigation concerning performance or financial management under United States Government federal award or subaward?			
	3.4	Procurements			
		Are formal procurement policies and procedures in place and being followed?			
		Have all special conditions of the award been met?			
				Finance and Procurement Scoring	
				High Risk	Medium Risk
				Low Risk	
		Total score for Finance and Procurement		0	
4	Technical Capacities				
	4.1	Experience			
		Did the company work under another organization/company?			
		How much money did they spend per year in the implementation of the project (s)?			
		Are the activities of the organization aligned with the mission and the values of the company ?			
	4.2	Leadership			
		During the last year has been a change in leadership?			
	4.3	Personnel and Consultants			
		Is the technical staff of the organization qualified and with enough experience?			
		What is the turnover of the technical staff?			
		Does the organization have a consultant database so they can hire a short-term consultant quickly?			
		Is the project functioning as described in application?			
		Is data provided to support project "goals/outcomes"?			
	4.4	Reporting			
		Have technical reports been submitted timely?			
		Have the reports been accurate? Have there been errors?			
	4.5	Monitoring and Evaluation			
		Does the organization have mechanisms to ensure good quality of the products?			
		Does the staff have access to a database with where they can access and download documents related to their work?			
				Technical Capacities Scoring	
				High Risk	Medium Risk
				Low Risk	
		Total score for Technical Capacities		0	
		Total Score in All Categories		0	

Instructions

- The table at the top of the page shows how each question is score 0-10 for Risk Assessment.
Each question will have a maximum of 10 points for high risk and 0 for low risk.
 - A score between 0-3 shows a low risk for that particular question
 - A score between 4-6 shows a Medium risk for that particular question
 - A score between 7-10 shows a high risk for that particular question
- The total sum of all the questions will determine the overall score for that section (section 1, 2, 3 or 4). The total score in each section and where that number is by analyzing the graphs/boxes (on the right) will determine the level of risk. It is important to notice that each section will have different scores (graphs/boxes on the right) depending on how many questions are being asked.

Annex K

Unallowable Costs

<https://www.govinfo.gov/app/details/CFR-2014-title2-vol1/CFR-2014-title2-vol1-sec200-410/summary>

Annex L

Examples for calculating per diem for HQ staff, note Field Staff have different percentages, however, the calculation is the same.

Notes:

- [General Services Administration](#) (GSA) establishes per diem rates for destinations within the lower 48 Continental United States (CONUS).
- The [Department of Defense](#) (DOD) establishes non-foreign rates which includes Alaska, Hawaii, and all U.S. Territories (Non-CONUS).
- The [State Department](#) establishes all foreign rates which are specific to major cities.
- Meal breakdown can be calculated in the following chart (note, for travel funded by USG programs, this table MUST be used): www.gsa.gov/travel/plan-book/per-diem-rates/mie-breakdown

i) Normal example with no exceptions

Traveler A, a staff from the HQ office, leaves for a trip to New York City on Monday morning in April. The flight is scheduled to leave at 9AM. The traveler returns back to home-of-record on Thursday by noon.

The M&IE rate is \$76, as per the GSA website.

The Partners' approved rate is 90% = \$68.4

The per diem received will be:

Monday = $\$68.4 \times 75\% = \51.80

Tuesday = \$68.40

Wednesday = \$68.40

Thursday = $\$68.4 \times 75\% = \51.80

Total per diem = $\$51.80 + \$68.40 + \$68.40 + \$51.80 = \$240.40$

ii) Departing from home early; arriving home late

Traveler B, a staff from the HQ office, leaves for a trip to Bogota, Colombia on Monday morning in April. The flight is scheduled to leave at 8:00AM. In order to catch the flight, Traveler B must leave the home-of-record at 5:30 AM in order to be at the airport two hours prior to departure. The traveler returns back to home-of-record on Thursday at 10PM.

The M&IE rate is \$105, as per the State Department website.

The Partners' approved rate is 90% = \$94.50

The per diem received will be:

Monday = \$94.50 (this is a travel day; however, since Traveler B is leaving the home-of-record before 6AM, as per [Section 14.5.2 M&IE Meal Breakdown](#), full per diem is applied)

Tuesday = \$94.50

Wednesday = \$94.50

Thursday = \$94.50 (this is a travel day; however, since Traveler B is arriving to the home-of-record after 7PM, as per [Section 14.5.2 M&IE Meal Breakdown](#), full per diem is applied)

Total per diem = \$94.50 + \$94.50 + \$94.50 + \$94.50 = \$378

iii) Some meals covered by other sources

Traveler C, a staff from HQ, attends a conference in Panama City, leaving on flight on Monday at 11AM, attending the conference on Tuesday – Thursday, and returning on Friday morning, arriving to home-of-record after 9PM. During the conference, meals are provided for breakfast and lunch.

The Panama City M&IE rate is \$99, as per the State Department website.

The Partners' approved rate is 90% = \$89.10

Meal breakdown is as follows, as per [Section 14.5.2](#):

Breakfast @ the \$89.10 = \$13; Lunch = \$22; Dinner = \$36; Incidentals = \$18 (numbers rounded to nearest dollar)

The per diem received will be:

Monday = \$89.10 * 75% = \$66.83 (Panama City is the destination city and the rate to utilize on this first travel day)

Tuesday = \$36 + \$18 = \$54 (Dinner plus incidentals)

Wednesday = \$36 + \$18 = \$54 (Dinner plus incidentals)

Thursday = \$36 + \$18 = \$54 (Dinner plus incidentals)

Friday = \$89.10 (this is a travel day; however, since Traveler C is arriving to the home-of-record after 7PM, as per [Section 14.5.2 M&IE Meal Breakdown](#), full per diem is applied; also, Panama City is the city of departure; hence, this rate is utilized)

Total per diem = \$66.83 + 54 + 54 + 54 + 89.10 = \$317.93

Annex M



PARTNERS *of the* AMERICAS
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Affidavit in lieu of Receipt

I certify the following charges are true and correct and made for the business purpose outlined below.

Purpose/Event:

<u>Date</u>	<u>Description</u>	<u>Amount</u>	<u>Payment Method</u>
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Signed,

Name

Date

1424 K Street NW Suite 700 Washington DC 20005 202.628.3300 www.partners.net

Acknowledgment of Receipt and Compliance to Policies

I hereby acknowledge that I have received the Dominican Republic Supplemental Manual for Personnel and Operations (herein referred to as “MANUAL”) for Partners Dominican Republic. I understand that the purpose of the MANUAL is to acquaint employees with the policies and procedures of Partners Dominican Republic, and to act as a reference for employees. I understand that the MANUAL reflects the policies and procedures in effect this date which may be changed by Partners Dominican Republic.

I understand that I am bound by the provisions of this MANUAL and that it is my responsibility to read and adhere to the contents set forth in the MANUAL. Furthermore, I acknowledge these policies and procedures as conditions of employment with the Partners Dominican Republic. I agree to comply with all policies contained within the MANUAL and to ask my supervisor any questions that I may have about it.

Print Name: _____

Employee Signature: _____ Date: _____